

Guidebook to Kerala

Re-Inventing Kerala Tourism Infrastructure

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Approved _____
Adviser

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I would also like to express my appreciation to my colleagues for their support and encouragement throughout my research journey. Their insights and discussions have been invaluable in shaping my ideas and refining my work.

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I am deeply grateful to all those who have contributed to the development of my thesis, and I acknowledge their invaluable support in shaping my research.

Prologue:

Nestled in the southwestern tip of India lies a tropical paradise known as Kerala. With its palm-fringed beaches, lush green backwaters, serene hill stations, and abundant wildlife, Kerala has long been hailed as a nature lover's dream destination. However, beneath the serene beauty lies a story of social, political, and environmental challenges that have shaped the state's tourism infrastructure.

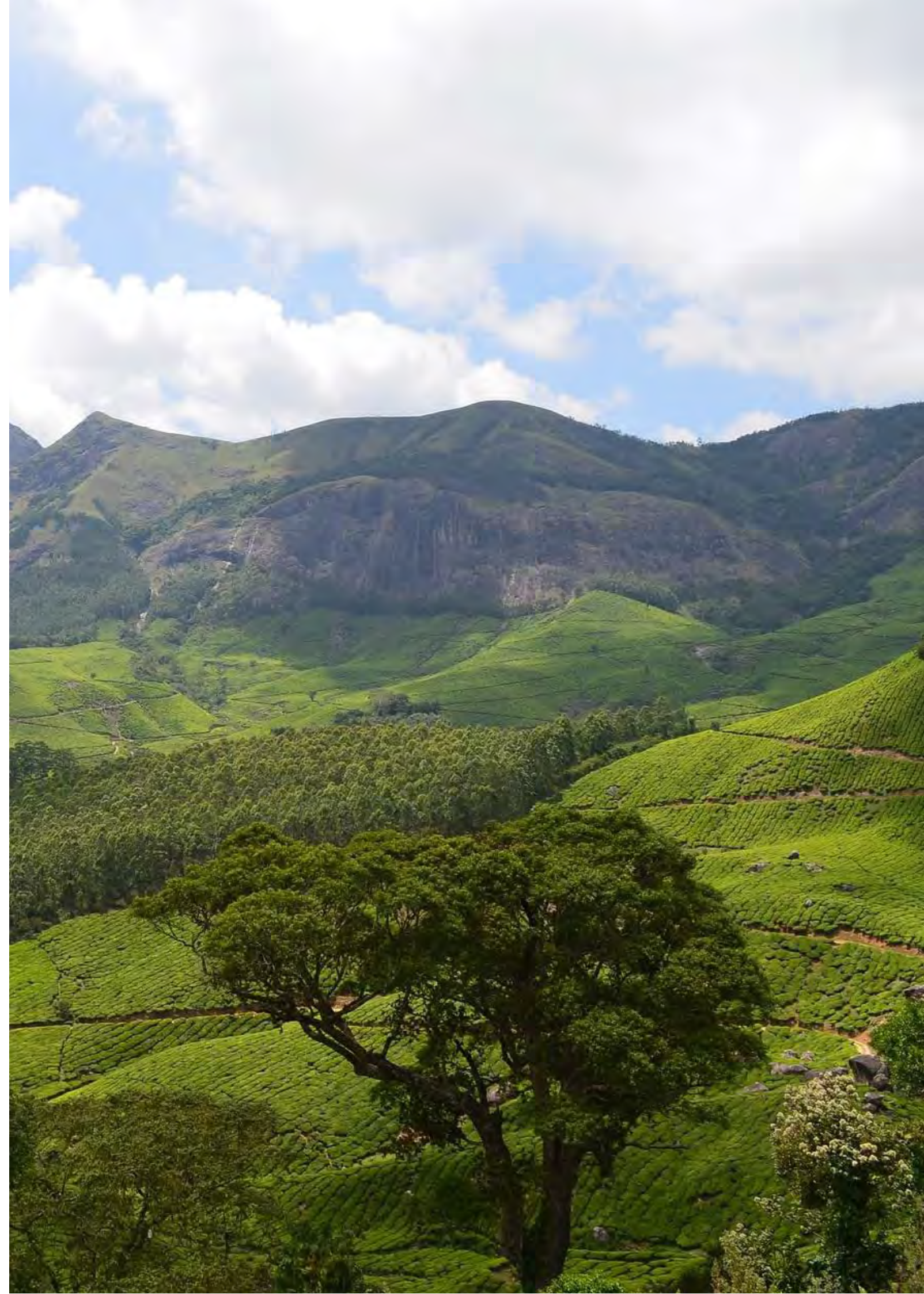
The book, "Guide to Kerala: Re-Inventing Kerala Tourism Infrastructure," delves into the rich history, present realities, and future possibilities of Kerala's tourism industry. It seeks to understand the social, political, and environmental factors that have influenced Kerala's journey toward sustainable tourism development. By examining the past and present scenarios, the book aims to chart a roadmap for the future, with the goal of making Kerala the world's best nature-based tourist destination.

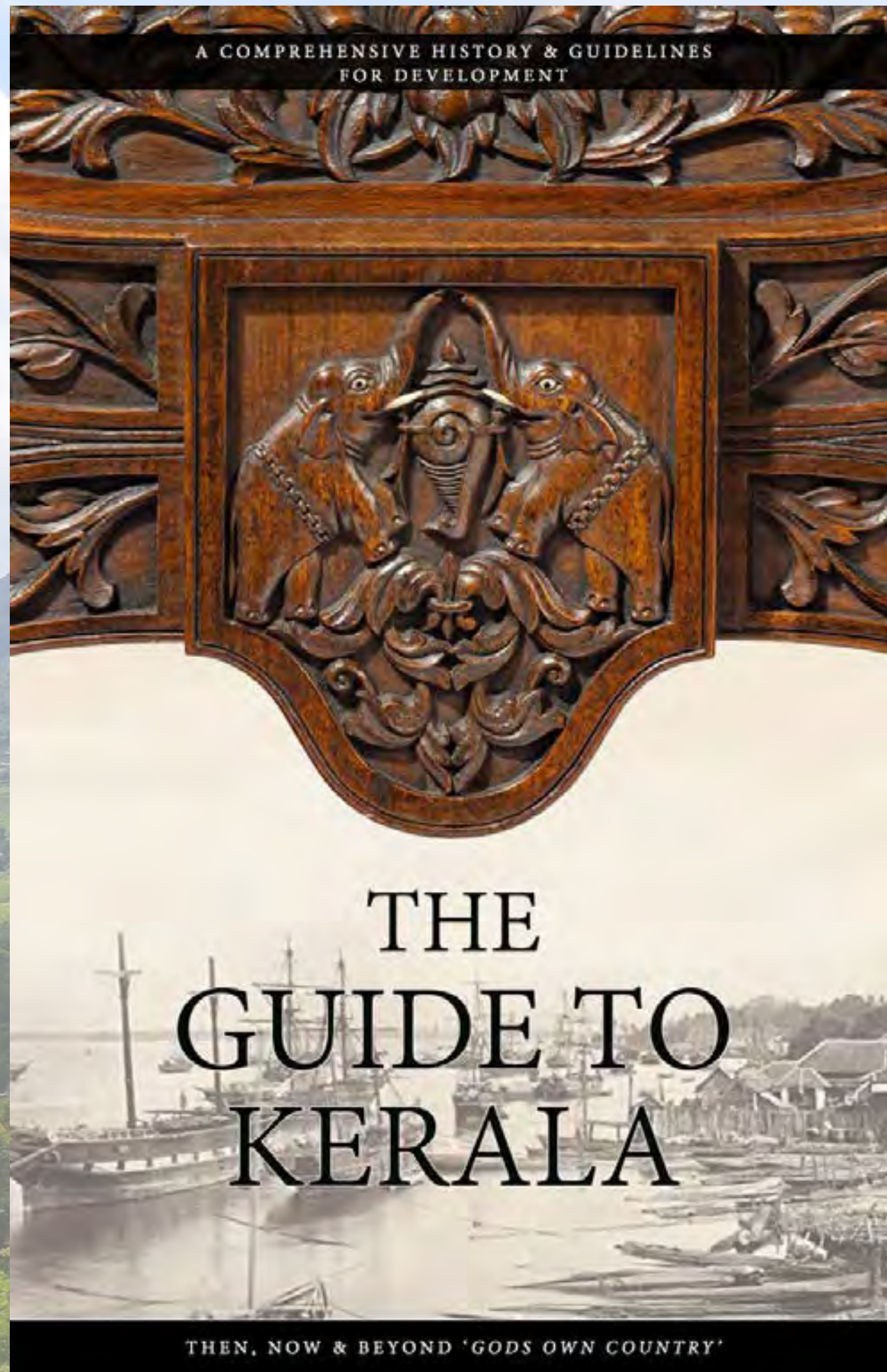
The journey to re-invent Kerala's tourism infrastructure has not been without its share of challenges. The state's history is marked by political turmoil, social inequalities, and environmental degradation. However, amidst these challenges, Kerala has also made significant strides in various spheres, including education, healthcare, and social welfare. The state's unique model of participatory democracy, known as the "Kerala Model," has been lauded for its inclusive approach to development and social justice. The book delves into the evolution of Kerala's tourism industry, from its early days as a destination for tea and spice plantations to its transformation into a global tourism hotspot. It examines the impacts of tourism on the state's environment, culture, and society, and the challenges it has posed in terms of sustainability. The book also delves into the policies and initiatives undertaken by the government and other stakeholders to promote sustainable tourism in Kerala, including ecotourism, community-based tourism, and responsible tourism.

The author draws upon his extensive research and fieldwork in Kerala to develop design strategies and guidelines for the sustainable development of the state's tourism infrastructure. He advocates for an integrated approach that considers the economic, social, and environmental aspects of tourism development, while also prioritizing the well-being of local communities and preserving Kerala's unique natural and cultural heritage.

Through the pages of this book, readers will be taken on a journey of discovery, exploring the diverse facets of Kerala's tourism industry, its challenges, and its potential. The author brings to light the need for sustainable development practices that balance economic growth with social and environmental concerns. Emphasizes the importance of community participation, responsible tourism practices, and conservation efforts to ensure that Kerala's tourism industry thrives in a way that is sustainable, inclusive, and respectful of the state's rich heritage.

As the prologue ends, readers are invited to join the author on a voyage of exploration, as he delves into the past, present, and future of Kerala's tourism industry. The challenges may be daunting, but we should be optimistic that with the right strategies and guidelines, Kerala can reinvent its tourism infrastructure and become a shining example of sustainable tourism for the world to emulate. The journey begins, and the pages that follow promise to be a compelling narrative of Kerala's quest to become the world's best nature-based tourist destination.





Contents

3	Acknowledgement
4	Prologue
5	Table of Contents
6	Glorious Kerala: Garden of Spices
14	Present Kerala & Reinvention: Why, What and How?
20	Re-Invention
23	Ecological Overkill & Need for Protection:
26	How Global Tourism Operates?
30	Tourist Gaze/John Urry
36	Responsible Tourism/Cape Town
40	National Tourists Route Project/Norway
44	Global Tourism Statistics
48	Environmental Management & Nature-Based Tourist Desinations
52	Tourist Map: Types of Tourism in Kerala and Development Guidelines
60	The Tourist Map
66	Backwater Tourism
82	Culture Tourism
92	History, Art & Architecture Tourism
106	Beach Tourism
120	Medical Tourism
128	Hill Station Tourism
138	Carbon Offsetting as an Investment Plan
144	Kerala 2040

GLORIOUS KERALA: Garden of Spices

In the luscious green rainforest of Kerala, the pepper plant was thriving. It was here, on the shores of the Malabar Coast, that countless adventurers had come searching for tasty trade goods over the millennia. The Sumerian records dating back to 3,000 BC referred to Kerala as the Garden of Spices. Ancient Babylonians, Assyrians, and Egyptians were all attracted to these Gardens over the years. By 600 BC, nomadic Arabs gained control of the spice trade and Arabia flourished. The knowledge of Kerala and its Garden of Spices was widespread, and its produce was highly coveted.

However, the dark ages slowly crept over Europe like a shadow, and the knowledge of Kerala and its Garden of Spices slipped out of time and mind. In order to protect their profits, Arab traders began telling stories about the dangerous nature of harvesting pepper. Myths of dragon-like serpents guarding the pepper trees circulated throughout Europe. It was said that only by burning down the trees could you extract the peppercorns, which also doubled as a convenient origin story explaining the color of black pepper.



The map shows the trade links between Muziris(Calicut) and the rest of the world.

The significance of Kerala on the world Map can be seen in this map. Pepper was introduced to the west from Calicut, Kerala. It was through Arabs and Romans the west got to know of pepper and the place where it grows. The west was fascinated to reach the spice garden of India. Today, the Roman gold coins used for these trade are kept intact in Museums.

Out of the dust of the fallen Roman Empire, Venice arose as a great naval power and soon controlled the Adriatic Sea. The Venetians were quick to dominate the distribution of pepper from Alexandria, and with naval superiority, they positioned themselves as modern-day drop shippers purchasing products from the Muslim-controlled Alexandria and reselling it on the European market. The price of pepper skyrocketed, and soon only the most wealthy were able to afford it. Pepper became a status symbol, a way for the rich to flaunt their wealth and affluence. It also doubled as a more stable form of currency than actual money.

In the late 15th century, the Portuguese were the first Europeans to reach India in search of pepper and other spices. They established trading posts and monopolized the pepper trade for several decades. Later, the Dutch, French, and British also entered the spice trade and competed for control of the lucrative pepper market. Over time, pepper became more widely available and affordable, and it found its way into almost every kitchen and restaurant around the world.



Frontispiece of volume 1.
This is the greatest ever contribution of the Dutch to the world of plants.
Hortus Malabaricus is the oldest important printed book on Indian medicinal plants. The 1st of its 12 volumes was published in 1678 from Amsterdam this book, written by H.A. Van Rhee is perhaps the only authentic record of the ethnohistorical knowledge of ancient Malabar, available to us today.

DUTCH MALABAR (1661-1795)
Portugese & Dutch Architectural Influence



Old Harbour Hotel, Fort Kochi – Portuguese & Dutch

DUTCH MALABAR (1661-1795)
Portugese & Dutch Architectural Influence



Matanchery Palace, Kochi - Dutch



Vasco da Gama's body was first buried at St. Francis Church, at Fort Kochi in the city of Kochi, but his remains were returned to Portugal in 1539 - Dutch



Bolgatty Palace, Kochi - Dutch



A pepper plantation in the hills of Thekkady, Kerala

Today, India remains one of the largest producers and exporters of pepper, along with other spices like cumin, coriander, and turmeric. Kerala, in particular, is known for its high-quality spices and remains an important source of spices for the world. The importance of Kerala in the spice trade has not diminished over the years, and the region's rich history is a testament to the power of trade and the impact that spices can have on cultures and societies.

Pepper has a long and fascinating history that spans thousands of years and multiple continents. It originated in the Western Ghats region of India and was traded extensively throughout the ancient world. Pepper was highly prized by ancient Greeks and Romans, who used it as a currency, a spice, and a medicine. It was known as "black gold" and was considered a symbol of wealth and luxury.

During the medieval period, pepper was traded along the famous Silk Road and became a valuable commodity for European merchants. The demand for pepper was so high that it led to the discovery of new trade routes and the establishment of European colonies in India and other parts of the world. The history of pepper is a testament to the power of trade and the impact that spices can have on cultures and societies.

The importance of Kerala in the spice trade cannot be overstated. The region's lush rainforests and rich history have made it a center for the production and export of high-quality spices like pepper. Kerala's importance in the spice trade has endured for thousands of years and will likely continue to do so in the future.

Present Kerala & Re-Invention: Why, What & How?

Since becoming a state in 1951, Kerala has undergone significant economic and social changes. Located in the southern part of India, Kerala is known for its unique social indicators such as high literacy rates, low infant mortality rates, and high life expectancy, which have been achieved through a strong emphasis on education, healthcare, and social welfare.



District Map, Kerala

The economy of Kerala has primarily been driven by remittances from its large diaspora working in foreign countries, especially in the Middle East. The state has also seen growth in sectors such as tourism, information technology, and healthcare. However, agriculture continues to be an important sector in the state, with a significant portion of the population engaged in farming, especially in the production of cash crops such as rubber, tea, coffee, and spices.

Kerala has a unique social fabric with a mix of different religions, cultures, and ethnicities. The state has a strong tradition of social welfare, with a focus on providing access to education, healthcare, and social security to its citizens. Kerala has also been a pioneer in implementing various social welfare schemes, such as the universal public distribution system (PDS) that provides subsidized food grains to the poor, and the mid-day meal program for school children.

Kerala has made significant progress in improving the standard of living of its citizens over the years. The state has one of the highest per capita income levels in India, and a relatively low poverty rate compared to other states. However, income inequality remains a challenge in Kerala, with disparities between different regions and social groups.

Kerala has consistently performed well on several social indicators. The state has achieved high literacy rates, with a strong emphasis on education, and has made significant progress in improving healthcare infrastructure and reducing mortality rates. However, the state also faces challenges such as high population density, environmental degradation, and an aging population.

Since becoming a state in 1951, Kerala has made remarkable progress in areas such as education, healthcare, and social welfare. The state has a unique social fabric and has been successful in achieving relatively high standards of living for its citizens. However, challenges such as income inequality, population density, and environmental degradation remain areas of concern that require continued efforts for sustainable development.

Tourism contributes to nearly 10% of the state's GDP.
Total GDP: US\$ 130 billion (2021-22)

Comparing Kerala and Countries by GDP
Equivalent to
Morocco: Rank 62(2018)
Czech Republic: Rank 47(2017)

GDP of Sri Lanka: 84 billion USD
GDP of New Mexico: 94 billion USD



The Human Development Index of various Indian States as of 2006 (prepared by United Nations Development Programme)

Human development indices seemed to show a standard of living that was comparable with life in developed nations, despite low-income rates. Despite having high standards of human development and 100% literacy rate, the Kerala model ranks low in terms of industrial and economic development.

Re-Invention:

Singapore

1980



2022



Netherlands

1980



2022

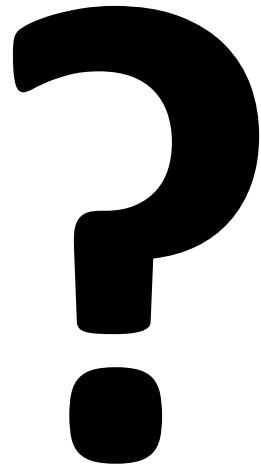


Kerala

2022



2040



The illustration demonstrates the need for a re-invention for Kerala by comparing it to Netherlands and Singapore.

The question of how should this re-invention be is demonstrated in this illustration. Singapore developed as a metropolis from 1980 to 2022 whereas Netherlands developed to bring more nature . Both of them are development that has boosted the local economy and contributed to the community. So, how should Kerala develop? Should it develop as a metropolis or utilize its nature to develop as a modern hub of sustainable tourism? The aim should be to bring a perfect balance of both.

Kerala, situated on the southwestern coast of India, is known for its natural beauty, cultural heritage, and unique tourist experiences. However, the unscientific use of natural resources and the increasing number of tourists visiting the state are posing serious threats to the environment. To ensure that Kerala remains a desirable tourist destination in the long run, it is imperative to focus on sustainable tourism practices.

Sustainable tourism refers to tourism activities that protect and conserve the natural environment while providing a positive created experience for tourists and benefiting local communities. In Kerala, sustainable tourism practices are essential because many of the environmental crises faced by the state are irreversible, meaning that the loss of natural resources is permanent.

Kerala’s economy heavily depends on tourism, which contributes nearly 10% of the state’s GDP, which was USD 130 billion in the 2021-22 financial year. The tourism industry’s growth has significantly contributed to Kerala’s economic development and job opportunities. However, this growth has come at a significant cost to the state’s natural environment. The unchecked tourism activities have resulted in deforestation, soil erosion, and degradation of water quality.

To address these environmental concerns, Kerala needs to adopt sustainable tourism practices that protect natural resources and biodiversity. For example, the state can promote eco-tourism, which emphasizes responsible tourism practices that minimize environmental impacts while providing tourists with authentic experiences. This can include activities such as trekking, wildlife safaris, and camping, which encourage visitors to appreciate the natural beauty of Kerala while respecting and protecting the environment.

In addition, Kerala can promote sustainable tourism practices through the development of sustainable infrastructure, such as green hotels and resorts, and the use of renewable energy sources to power tourism facilities. The state can also implement policies and regulations that promote sustainable tourism practices, such as limiting the number of tourists allowed in ecologically sensitive areas and imposing fines on those who violate environmental regulations.

The development of sustainable tourism practices in Kerala will not only benefit the environment but also boost the state’s economy. Sustainable tourism can provide long-term economic benefits by attracting more tourists who are willing to pay a premium for eco-friendly and socially responsible tourism experiences. It can also create job opportunities for the local community, including those in the tourism industry and related sectors such as agriculture and handicrafts.

Moreover, sustainable tourism practices can also help to preserve Kerala’s unique cultural heritage, which is an important aspect of the state’s tourism industry. Kerala has a rich history and cultural traditions, including Ayurveda, classical dance forms, and traditional architecture. By promoting sustainable tourism practices, Kerala can preserve its cultural heritage and ensure that future generations can learn about and appreciate the state’s cultural richness.

Kerala is a popular tourist destination that faces significant environmental challenges. The adoption of sustainable tourism practices is essential to ensure that the state’s natural resources are protected and conserved while providing tourists with unique and authentic experiences. Sustainable tourism practices can also benefit the local community and preserve Kerala’s cultural heritage. As Kerala continues to develop as a sustainable tourist state, it can serve as a model for other regions seeking to balance economic development with environmental conservation.

Ecological Overkill & Need for Protection

Challenges/Issues? Boom in Tourism

The backwaters of Kerala in India are a maze of lakes, streams, and lagoons with a unique ecosystem. Over the years, a variety of challenges have affected the backwaters and threatened the ecosystem, such as contamination from pesticides that farmers use in paddy fields, dumping of chemical emissions from factories and sewage from cities, unregulated sand dredging for construction, and in recent decades, the tourism boom that has worsened water pollution.



Kochi Marina



Backwater based resorts



Backwater based resorts

- Environmental degradation: The backwater ecosystems are under severe threat due to pollution, encroachment, and overfishing, which has impacted the livelihoods of the fishing communities.
- Climate change: Climate change has led to erratic weather patterns, resulting in changes in the fishing season and a decline in fish catch, affecting the livelihoods of fishing communities.
- Lack of infrastructure: The backwater regions lack basic infrastructure such as roads, transport facilities, and healthcare facilities, making it difficult for the communities to access essential services.
- Unemployment: The backwater communities have limited opportunities for employment and often rely solely on fishing for their livelihoods. This lack of alternative livelihood options can make them vulnerable to poverty and exploitation.
- Marginalization: The backwater communities are often marginalized and have limited access to resources and political power. This makes it difficult for them to have their voices heard and their concerns addressed by policymakers.
- Social issues: There are also social issues such as alcoholism, domestic violence, and lack of access to education that affect the backwater communities and hinder their progress.

The backwater based communities in Kerala face a complex set of challenges that require a comprehensive and sustainable approach to address their needs and improve their livelihoods.

Why is there a need for the Re-Invention of Kerala?

How should Kerala develop in 20 years?

The unscientific use of natural resources and the increasing number of tourists visiting the state are posing serious threats to the environment. To ensure that Kerala remains a desirable tourist destination in the long run, it is imperative to focus on sustainable tourism practices.

Sustainable tourism refers to tourism activities that protect and conserve the natural environment while providing a positive created experience for tourists and benefiting local communities. In Kerala, sustainable tourism practices are essential because many of the environmental crises faced by the state are irreversible, meaning that the loss of natural resources is permanent.

Kerala's economy heavily depends on tourism, which contributes nearly 10% of the state's GDP, which was USD 130 billion in the 2021-22 financial year. The tourism industry's growth has significantly contributed to Kerala's economic development and job opportunities. However, this growth has come at a significant cost to the state's natural environment. The unchecked tourism activities have resulted in deforestation, soil erosion, and degradation of water quality.

To address these environmental concerns, Kerala needs to adopt sustainable tourism practices that protect natural resources and biodiversity. For example, the state can promote eco-tourism, which emphasizes responsible tourism practices that minimize environmental impacts while providing tourists with authentic experiences. This can include activities such as trekking, wildlife safaris, and camping, which encourage visitors to appreciate the natural beauty of Kerala while respecting and protecting the environment.

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The development of sustainable tourism practices in Kerala will not only benefit the environment but also boost the state's economy. Sustainable tourism can provide long-term economic benefits by attracting more tourists who are willing to pay a premium for eco-friendly and socially responsible tourism experiences. It can also create job opportunities for the local community, including those in the tourism industry and related sectors such as agriculture and handicrafts.

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Kerala is a popular tourist destination that faces significant environmental challenges. The adoption of sustainable tourism practices is essential to ensure that the state's natural resources are protected and conserved while providing tourists with unique and authentic experiences. Sustainable tourism practices can also benefit the local community and preserve Kerala's cultural heritage. As Kerala continues to develop as a sustainable tourist state, it can serve as a model for other regions seeking to balance economic development with environmental conservation.

What is this Re-Invention?

'Develop City for Citizens'

Despite being a major tourist destination, Kerala is still grappling with a number of issues such as environmental degradation, lack of proper waste management, inadequate infrastructure, and unsustainable tourism practices. In order to address these issues and to develop Kerala as a city that is developed for its citizens along with tourists with sustainable tourism, there is a need for a concerted effort from various stakeholders.

The development of Kerala as a city that is developed for its citizens along with tourists with sustainable tourism can bring about a number of benefits. Firstly, it can help to improve the quality of life of the citizens of Kerala by providing them with better infrastructure, healthcare facilities, and employment opportunities. This, in turn, can help to reduce poverty and promote economic growth in the state. Secondly, it can help to preserve the natural beauty and cultural heritage of Kerala, which is a major attraction for tourists. By adopting sustainable tourism practices, the state can ensure that the environment is not degraded and that the cultural heritage is protected for future generations.

In order to achieve the development of Kerala as a city that is developed for its citizens along with tourists with sustainable tourism, there are a number of steps that need to be taken. Firstly, there is a need for proper planning and management of tourism activities. This includes developing a comprehensive tourism policy that takes into account the needs of both tourists and local communities. The policy should also ensure that tourism activities are carried out in a sustainable manner, with a focus on minimizing the impact on the environment and local communities.

Secondly, there is a need to invest in infrastructure development. This includes improving the transportation network, developing better healthcare facilities, and providing basic amenities such as clean drinking water and sanitation facilities. Such investments can not only benefit tourists but also improve the quality of life of local communities.

Thirdly, there is a need to promote community participation in tourism activities. This can be done by encouraging local communities to participate in the development and management of tourism activities, and by providing them with training and capacity-building support. This can help to ensure that local communities benefit from tourism activities and that their cultural heritage is preserved.

Fourthly, there is a need to adopt sustainable tourism practices. This includes promoting eco-tourism and responsible tourism practices, reducing the use of plastics and promoting waste management, and promoting the use of renewable energy sources. By adopting such practices, the state can ensure that tourism activities are carried out in an environmentally sustainable manner.

The development of Kerala as a city that is developed for its citizens along with tourists with sustainable tourism is a complex task that requires a concerted effort from various stakeholders. However, by adopting a comprehensive approach that takes into account the needs of both tourists and local communities, and by promoting sustainable tourism practices, the state can achieve sustainable and inclusive growth. This, in turn, can help to preserve the natural beauty and cultural heritage of Kerala and improve the quality of life of its citizens.

How should this Re-Invention be?

There are several reasons why there is a need for the reinvention of Kerala in its architecture front:

Preservation of cultural heritage:

Kerala has a rich cultural heritage that is reflected in its traditional architecture. However, much of this heritage is at risk of being lost due to rapid urbanization and modernization. By reinventing Kerala's architecture, it is possible to preserve and promote its unique cultural identity.

Climate-responsive design:

Kerala's tropical climate presents unique challenges when it comes to designing buildings that are energy-efficient, comfortable, and sustainable. By reinventing its architecture, it is possible to develop designs that are more responsive to the local climate and environmental conditions.

Economic development:

Architecture is an important part of the tourism industry, and Kerala has the potential to attract more tourists by showcasing its unique architecture. By reinventing its architecture, Kerala can create new opportunities for economic growth and development.

Social and community development:

Architecture is not just about buildings, but also about creating spaces that foster community and social interaction.

By reinventing its architecture, Kerala can create more livable and sustainable communities that promote social cohesion and well-being.

Sustainable Tourism will develop Kerala as a model state

Tourism is one of the key industries in Kerala, and it has been growing rapidly over the years. However, the growth of tourism has also brought in its wake a range of environmental, social, and cultural problems. To overcome these challenges and develop Kerala as a developed and model state, sustainable tourism can play a crucial role. Some ways in which sustainable tourism can contribute to the development of Kerala:

Environmental protection:

Sustainable tourism can help preserve Kerala's rich biodiversity, natural resources, and cultural heritage. This can be achieved through eco-tourism initiatives, responsible waste management, and conservation efforts.

Community development:

Sustainable tourism can empower local communities, promote their culture and traditions, and provide them with employment opportunities. Community-based tourism initiatives can ensure that the benefits of tourism are shared among all stakeholders, including the local population.

Economic growth:

Sustainable tourism can generate income for the state, promote entrepreneurship and create jobs in various sectors such as agriculture, handicrafts, and hospitality. This can help Kerala become a developed and model state.

Infrastructure development:

Sustainable tourism can drive infrastructure development in Kerala, including roads, airports, and accommodations. This can improve connectivity, enhance the quality of life, and attract more tourists to the state.

Education and awareness:

Sustainable tourism can help raise awareness about environmental, social, and cultural issues among tourists and the local population. This can lead to a better understanding and appreciation of the local culture and traditions, and foster responsible tourism practices.

The development of sustainable tourism can have a transformative impact on Kerala, making it a model state for others to follow. By promoting responsible tourism practices, protecting the environment, empowering local communities, and driving economic growth, Kerala can become a sustainable tourism destination of choice, attracting tourists from around the world while preserving its unique identity and heritage.

How Global Tourism Operates?

Tourist Gaze

John Urry

Responsible Tourism

Cape Town

**National Tourist
Routes Project**

Norway

Tourist Gaze

John Urry

There is no single tourist gaze as such. It varies by society, by social group, and by historical period. Such gazes are constructed through differences

Global tourism is a complex and dynamic industry that involves the movement of people across borders for leisure, business, or other purposes. John Urry's "Tourist Gaze" theory emphasizes the role of tourism in shaping and constructing social identities, cultural practices, and economic relationships. It argues that tourists are not passive consumers of attractions, but active participants in the creation and transformation of tourist experiences.

Difference between ordinary and extraordinary should be established

1. Famous for being famous



eg: Eiffel Tower, the Grand Canyon, Empire State Building, Taj Mahal etc.

Attracts or hopes to see some of these objects during a lifetime

Difference between ordinary and extraordinary should be established

2. Seeing particular signs



eg: typical English village, typical American skyscraper, typical German beer garden, typical French chateau etc.

This mode of gazing shows how tourists are in a way semioticians, reading the landscape for signifiers of certain pre-established notions of signs derived from various discourses of travel and tourism.

Difference between ordinary and extraordinary should be established

3. Seeing unfamiliar aspects of what had previously been thought of as familiar



eg: Some tourism in China has been of this sort. Visitors have found it particularly interesting to gaze upon the carrying out of domestic tasks in a 'communist' country and hence to see how the routines of life are surprisingly not that unfamiliar.

Expects unfamiliar experience but in reality its very familiar and common

Changing economics of the Tourist Industry

‘It should be noted that almost all the services provided to tourists have to be delivered at the time and place at which they are produced’

eg: Food Tourism as part of Houseboat and Backwater tourism

Tourists live and travel in a houseboat and they get to be part of fishing or they purchase from local farmers or village shops and in-house chefs in houseboats prepare the food as per the choice of the guests.

If the particular place does not convey appropriate cultural meanings, the quality of the specific service may well be tarnished. There is, therefore a crucial ‘spacial fixity’ about tourist services.



Food prepared for guests in the houseboat.

The speciality is that, the tourists can involve in the activities such as fishing, or local products purchases from local vendors while travelling in the houseboats and can involve in the cooking with the chefs onboard. According to the number of days of stay in a houseboat, the tourists have the luxury to have a custom food prepared for them from the chef on the moving vessel.



Tourist enjoying the food in a Houseboat.

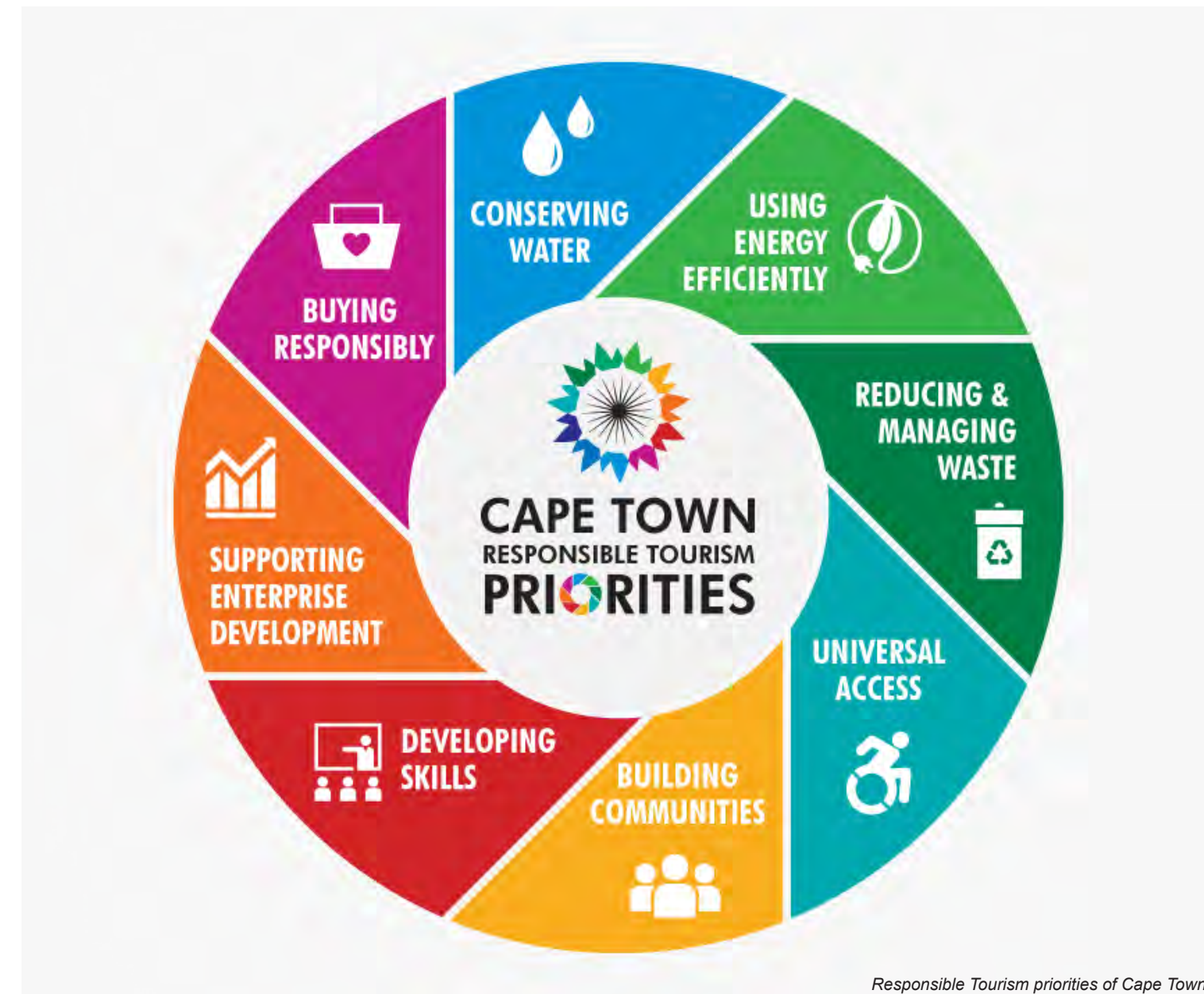
*Source: Mark Wiens/YouTube channel
The program documented a detailed video on life on a Houseboat in Alleppey, Kerala*

Responsible Tourism

Cape Town

“Creates better places for people to live in, and better places to visit”

Responsible tourism is an approach to tourism that seeks to minimize the negative impacts of tourism on the environment, local communities, and cultural heritage, while maximizing the positive benefits for all stakeholders. The Cape Town responsible tourism initiative is a prime example of this approach, with its focus on promoting sustainable tourism practices that respect the environment, support local businesses, and empower communities.



Source: <https://www.capetown.travel/travelwise/responsible-tourism/>
The website is an excellent source of information on how Cape Town conducts its Responsible Tourism through various strategies over a period of time and its stakeholders

Cape Town is one of the world’s premier tourism destinations, with approximately 2 172, 836 international and domestic visitors in 2016 and R14,1 billion being spent by tourists in 2016.

However, tourism is not just a means to economic growth; it’s also a field through which operators and tourism businesses can help create positive social, economic, cultural and environmental interactions in our country. Responsible tourism aims to meet these needs of tourists and the needs of our city.

Many tourists nowadays are also looking for a more unique travel experience and intimate relationship with the countries they visit. They also want to leave knowing that their trip or travel did not have any negative impact or effects on the people or the environment they were in.

What is Responsible Tourism?

Responsible Tourism is tourism ‘that creates better places for people to live in, and better places to visit’

- **minimizes negative economic, environmental, and social impacts**
- **generates greater economic benefits for local people and enhances the well being of host communities**
- **improves working conditions and access to the industry**
- **involves local people in decisions that affect their lives and life chances**
- **makes positive contributions to the conservation of natural and cultural heritage embracing diversity**
- **provides more enjoyable experiences for tourists through more meaningful connections with local people, and a greater understanding of local cultural, social, and environmental issues**
- **provides access for physically challenged people**
- **is culturally sensitive, encourages respect between tourists and hosts, and builds local pride and confidence**

Is Responsible Tourism different from Sustainable Tourism?

Responsible tourism and sustainable tourism have the same goal: sustainable development. The pillars of responsible tourism are therefore the same as those of sustainable tourism - environmental integrity, social justice, and maximizing local economic benefits. The major difference between the two is that, in responsible tourism, individuals, organizations, and businesses are asked to take responsibility for their actions and the impacts of their actions.

Responsible tourism makes business sense

A significant and growing number of tourists are looking for a better experience, a better-quality product. They are looking for experiences that enable them to get closer to the “real” living culture of countries and to experience the diverse natural and cultural heritage. This is a global trend in the established markets as consumer expectations of their holidays change, people are taking more, shorter trips, and they expect to get more from them. In commercial market research, UK holidaymakers were asked whether or not they would be more likely to book a holiday with a company if they had a written code to guarantee good working conditions, protect the environment and support charities in the tourist destination. In 1999 45% said yes, when the question was asked again in 2001 52% said yes.

National Tourist Routes Project

Norway

Resting, Recollecting,
and Reflecting

In 1994, the Norwegian Roads Administration started a project to increase the attractiveness of eighteen scenic routes from Jæren in the south to Varanger in the far north.



The Norway tourist routes project is an example of how tourism can be used to promote sustainable development and cultural heritage. This project aims to create a network of scenic routes that showcase Norway's natural beauty and cultural heritage, while also promoting sustainable tourism practices that minimize the impact on the environment and support local communities.

The eighteen routes are not connected. The idea behind the project was not to send tourists on a predefined round trip but to invite them to make detours and discover spots they would otherwise have ignored and made small design interventions for tourists to interact.



Small interventions across all the selected locations makes the whole project connected and helps the visitors to stop and interact with nature.

Source: [https://www.visitnorway.com/Norwegian Scenic Routes](https://www.visitnorway.com/Norwegian%20Scenic%20Routes)



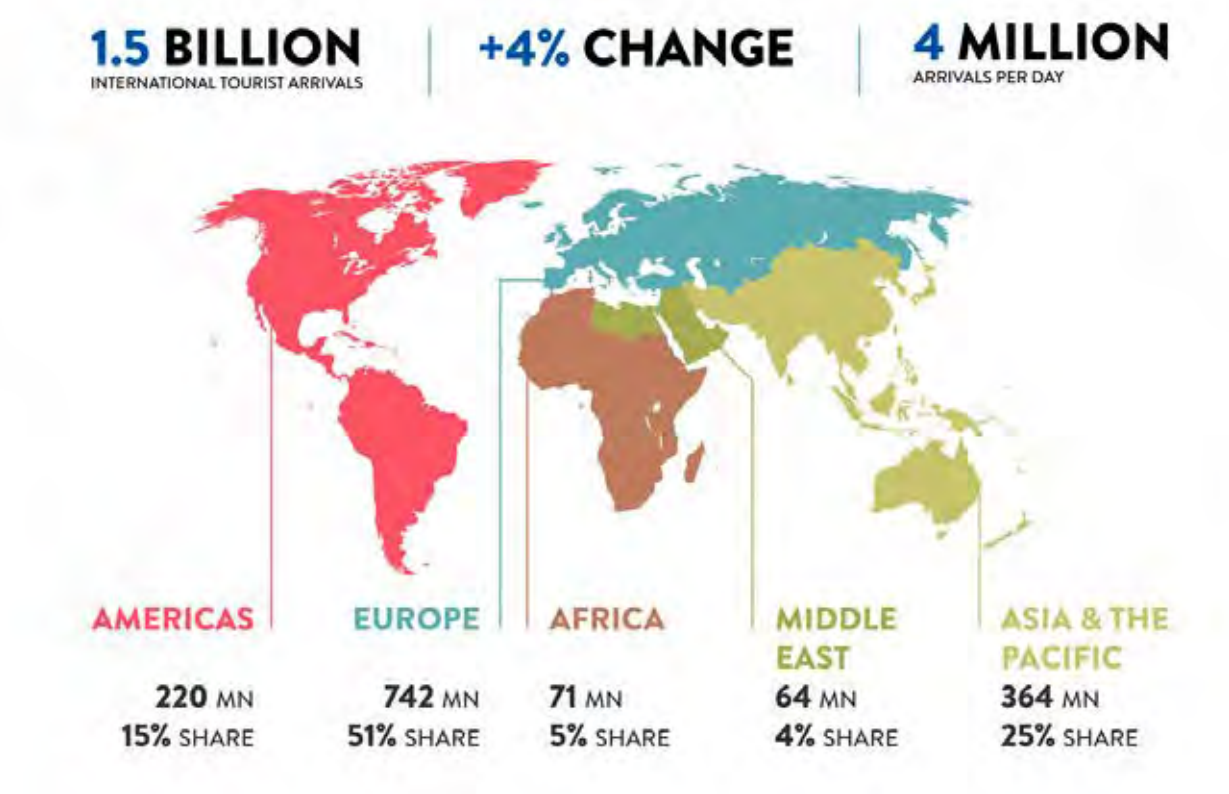
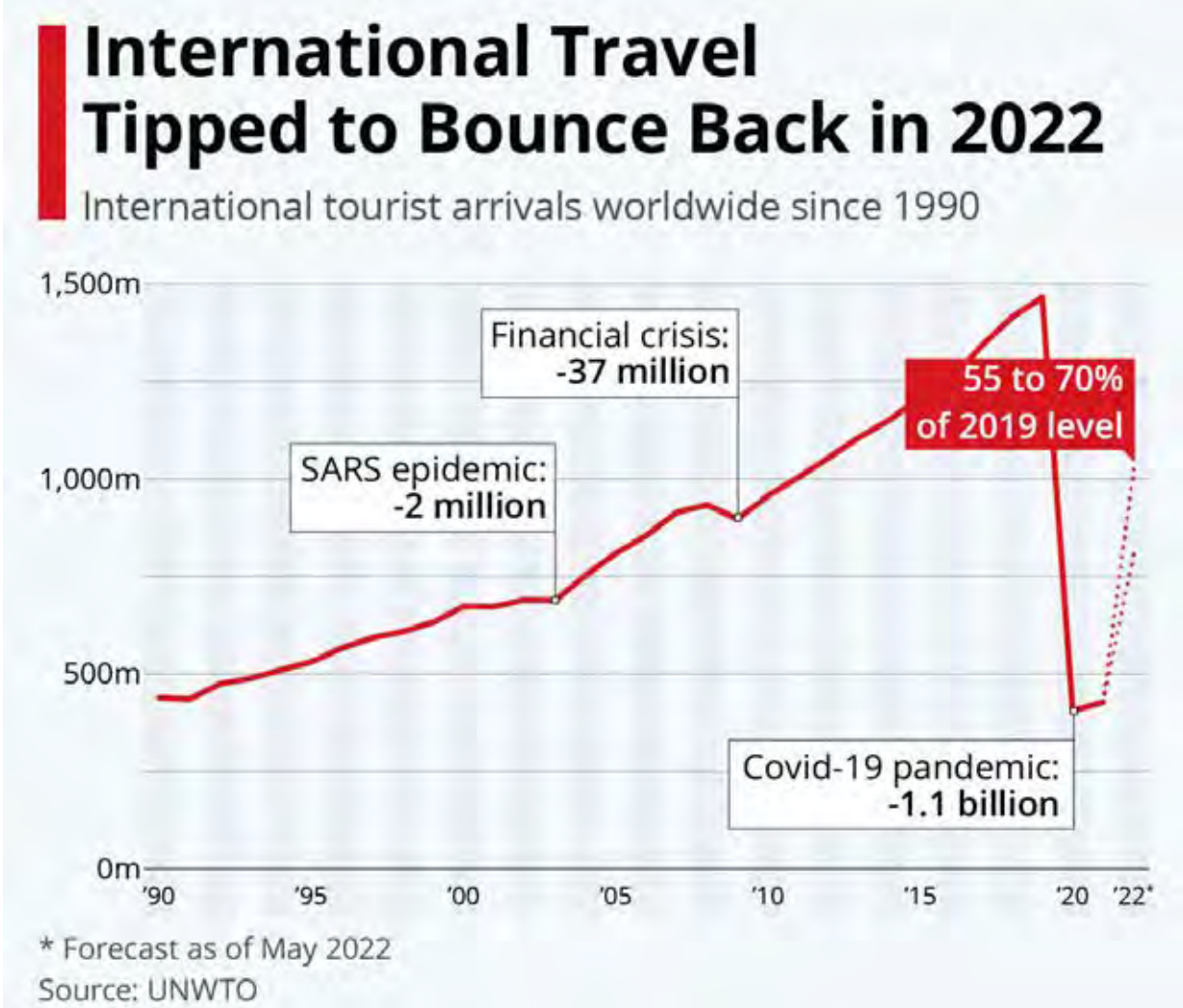
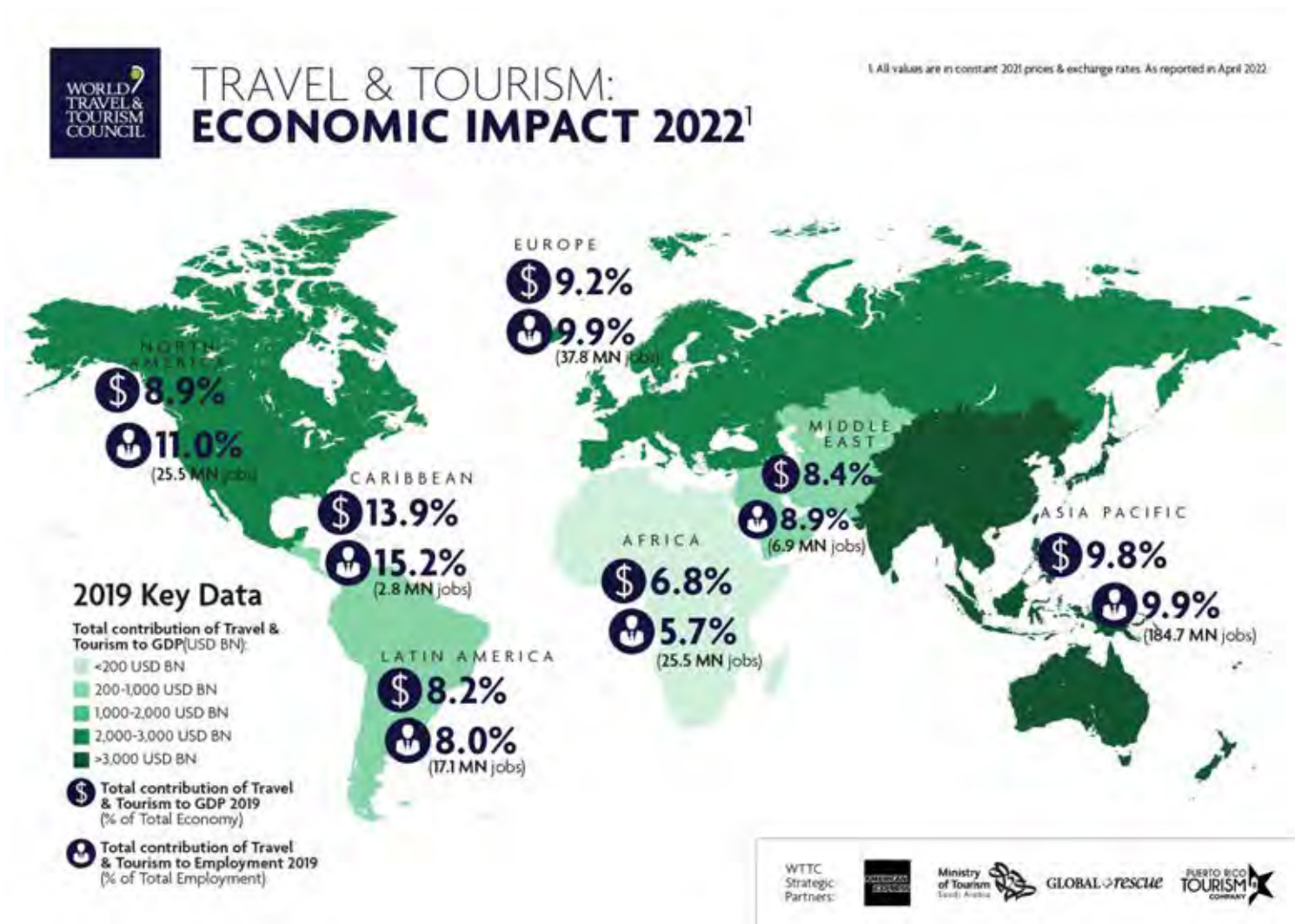
Global Tourism Statistics

How is tourism changing and where are people travelling?

Tourism has become a significant global industry, contributing to economic growth and development in many countries. As people become more affluent and accessible transportation options increase, tourism has experienced significant growth over the past few decades. In this analysis, we will examine global tourism statistics and specifically focus on nature-based tourism statistics.

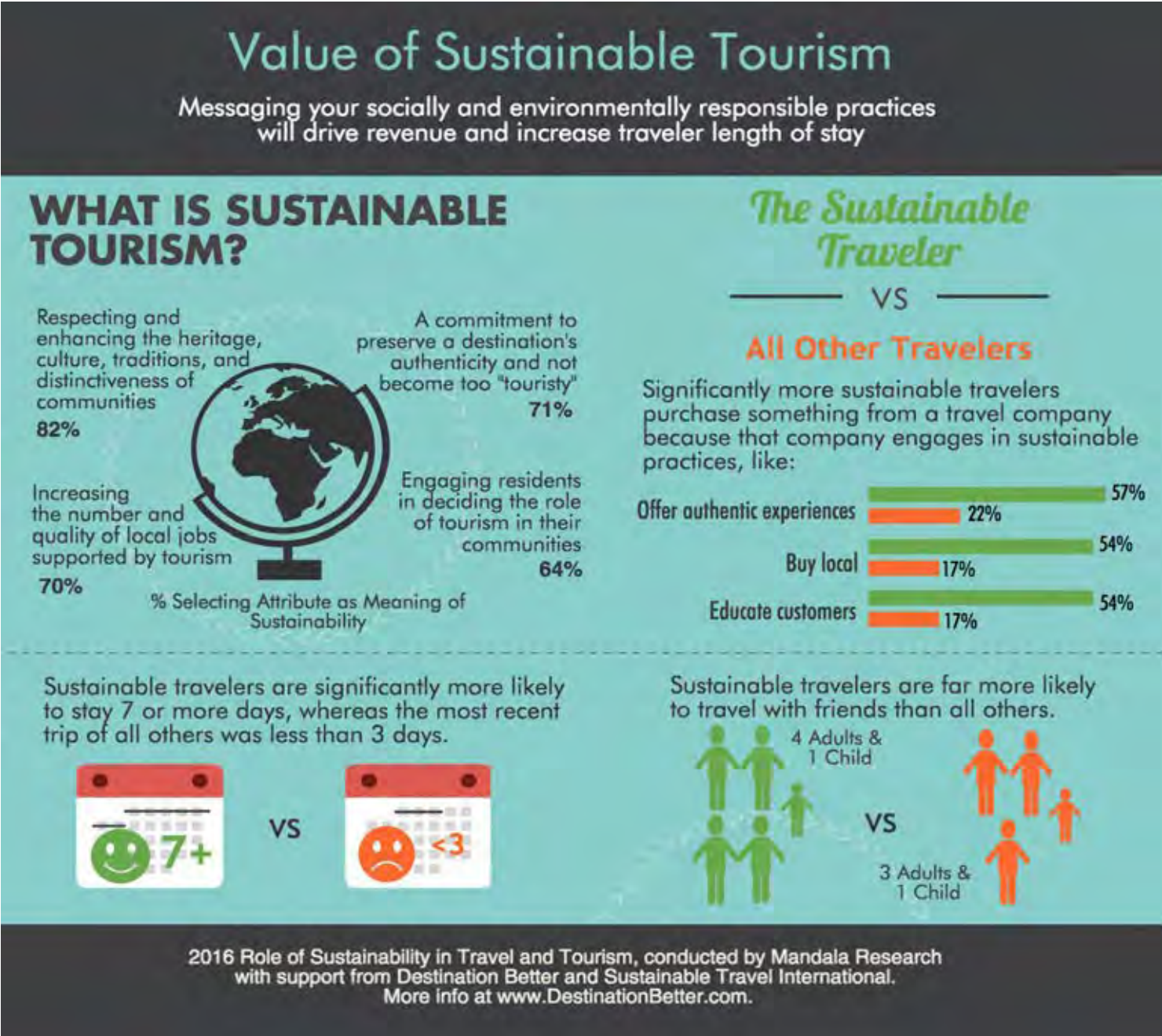
Global Tourism Statistics: According to the World Tourism Organization (UNWTO), international tourist arrivals reached 1.5 billion in 2019, representing a 4% increase compared to the previous year. This growth was driven by various factors, including increased disposable income, improved transportation options, and changing travel behaviors among global travelers.

Europe remains the most visited region, with 51% of global international tourist arrivals in 2019, followed by Asia and the Pacific with 24% of arrivals. The Americas accounted for 16%, Africa for 5%, and the Middle East for 4% of international tourist arrivals. The top international tourism destinations in 2019 were France, Spain, the United States, China, and Italy.



In terms of tourism receipts, the total expenditure by international tourists reached USD 1.5 trillion in 2019, with the top destinations being the United States, Spain, France, Thailand, and China. This indicates that while Europe remains the most visited region, other regions such as Asia and the Americas are also experiencing significant growth in terms of tourism expenditure.

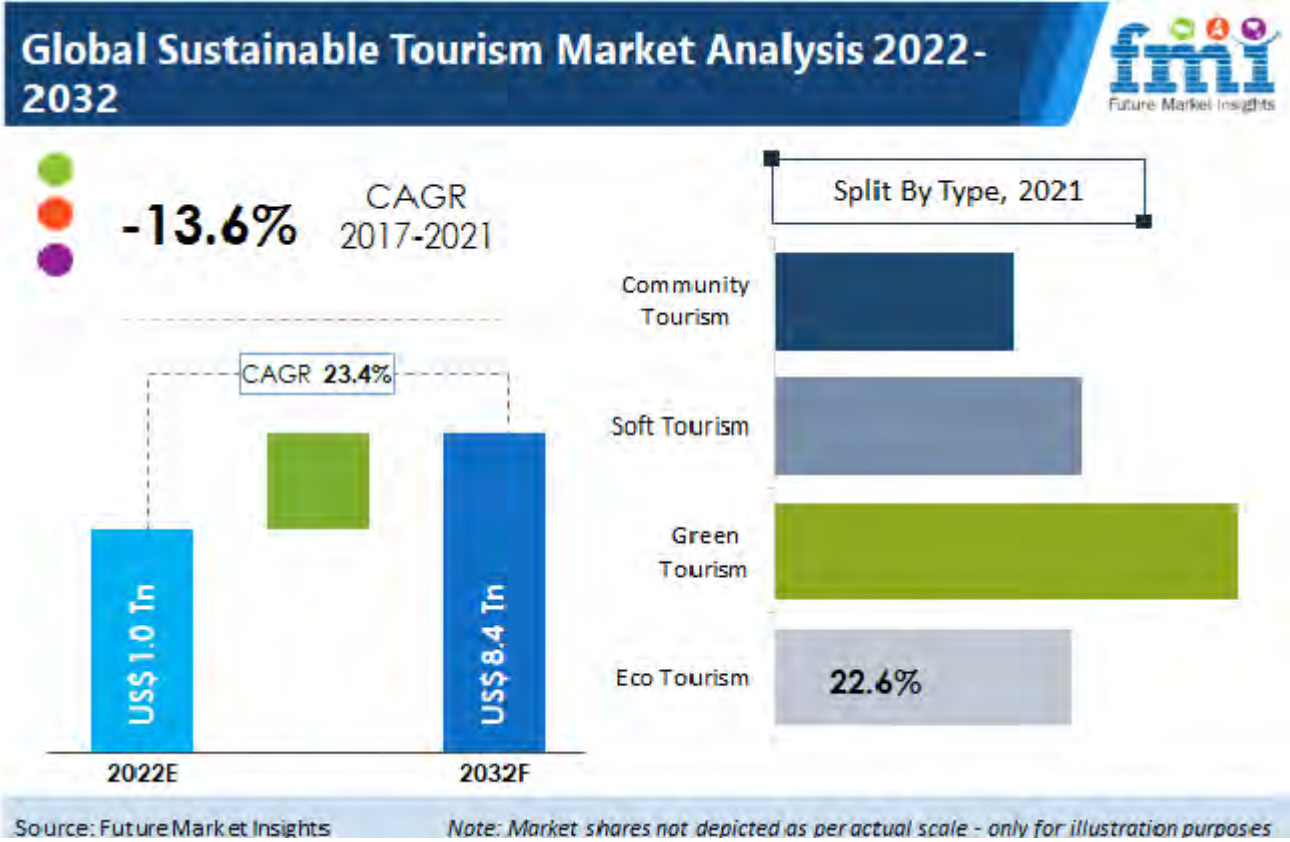
Nature-Based Tourism Statistics:



Nature-based tourism, also known as ecotourism or sustainable tourism, focuses on experiencing natural environments and their cultural heritage while conserving the environment and benefiting local communities. Nature-based tourism has gained popularity in recent years as travelers increasingly seek authentic and sustainable experiences in natural settings.

According to the International Union for Conservation of Nature (IUCN), nature-based tourism is growing at an estimated rate of 10-15% per year. It is estimated that nature-based tourism accounts for approximately 20% of global tourism and generates around USD 600 billion in revenue annually. This indicates the growing demand for nature-based tourism experiences and its significant contribution to the global tourism industry.

Attribute	Details
Estimated Sustainable Tourism Market Size 2022	US\$ 1.0 Trillion
Projected Market Size (2032)	US\$ 8.4 Trillion
Value CAGR (2022 to 2032)	23.4%
Sustainable Tourism Market Top Players' Share in 2021	2%-5%



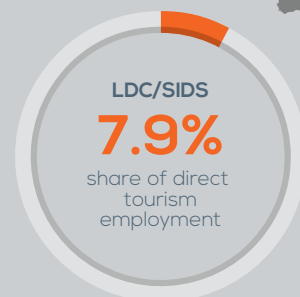
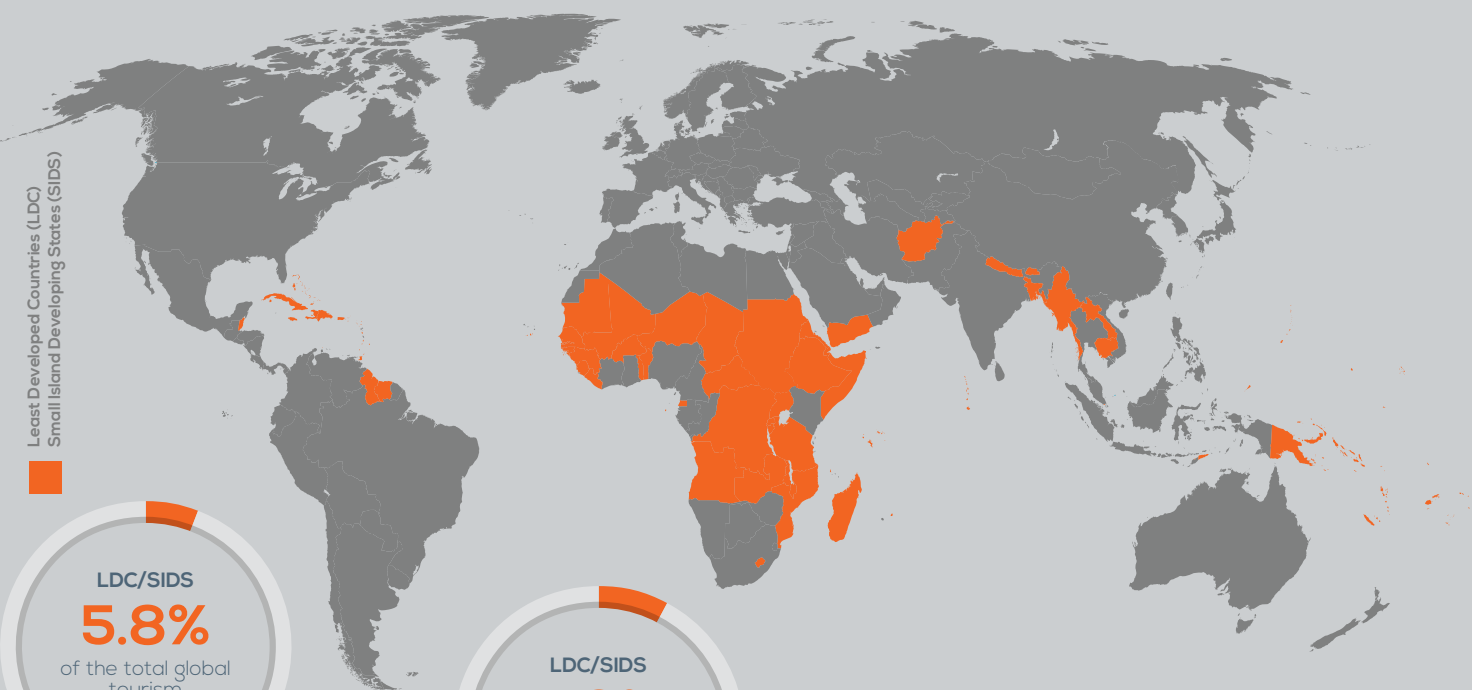
Several regions are known for their nature-based tourism offerings. For example, Africa is known for its wildlife safaris and natural reserves, such as the Serengeti National Park in Tanzania and the Kruger National Park in South Africa. South America is famous for its Amazon rainforest and the Galapagos Islands in Ecuador, while Australia is renowned for its unique wildlife and the Great Barrier Reef. Nature-based tourism also has positive environmental and social impacts. It can contribute to biodiversity conservation, support local economies, and promote cultural heritage preservation. Additionally, nature-based tourism often involves community engagement and can provide livelihood opportunities for local communities, helping to alleviate poverty and improve their well-being. However, there are also challenges associated with nature-based tourism. Activities such as wildlife viewing, hiking, and diving can have negative impacts on the environment if not managed sustainably. Over-tourism, habitat degradation, pollution, and disturbance to wildlife are some of the challenges that need to be addressed to ensure the sustainability of nature-based tourism.

Global tourism and nature-based tourism are significant contributors to the global economy. While global tourism continues to grow, nature-based tourism is also gaining popularity as travelers seek authentic and sustainable experiences in natural settings. It has positive impacts on the environment and local communities, but also faces challenges that need to be addressed for its long-term sustainability. As the tourism industry continues to evolve, it is crucial to prioritize sustainable practices to ensure that nature-based tourism can continue to thrive while conserving the environment and benefiting local communities.

2016 GLOBAL SUSTAINABLE TOURISM DASHBOARD

Development

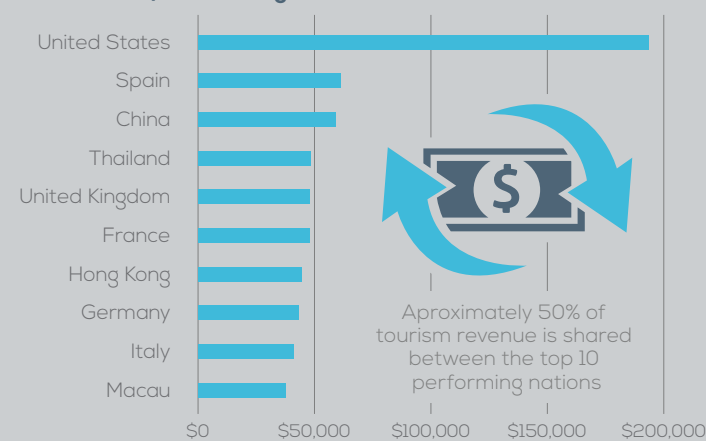
A small, but slowly increasing, share of tourism goes to developing countries



Distribution

Travel activity is highly concentrated

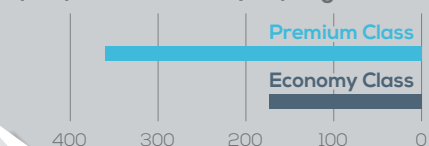
Top 10 countries for inbound tourism and their export earnings 2015



Travel and tourism expenditure is measured in US Dollars (Million)

Aviation Emissions

Carbon Dioxide Emissions per person one-way trip (kg) – 2015



Passenger travel aviation emissions in 2015
566Mt of CO₂

Resource Efficiency

Resource efficiency in the accommodation sector is improving

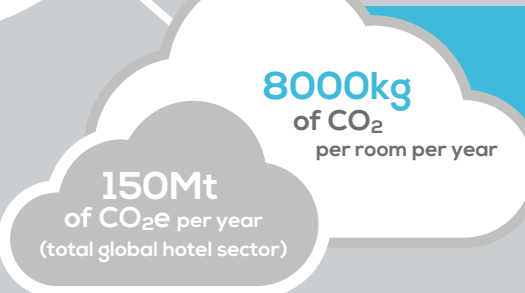
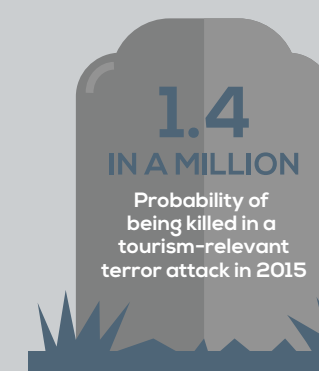


Percentage reduction in resource use compared with previous year (per guest per night)

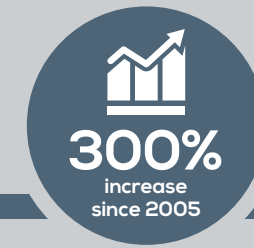


Security

and terror-related fatalities

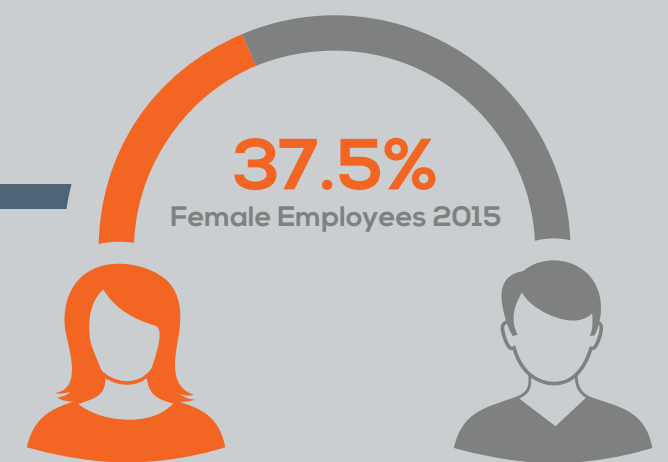


Environmentally leading hotels are improving their efficiency by several percent each year



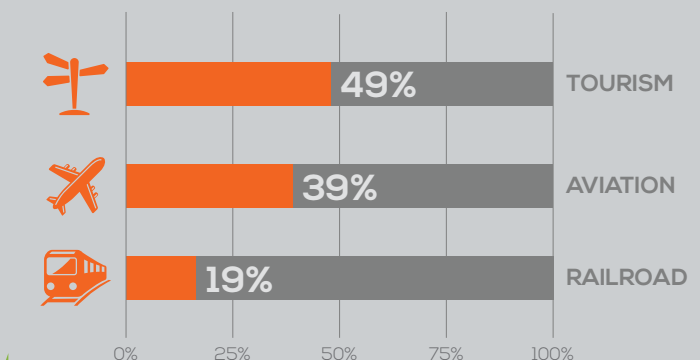
Gender Equity

within the travel and tourism industry



Protected Areas

Tourism Planning in World Heritage Areas is not widespread

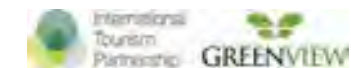


Griffith UNIVERSITY
Professor Susanne Becken

UNIVERSITY OF SURREY
Professor Graham Miller

Data compiled and aggregated in collaboration with:

amadeus



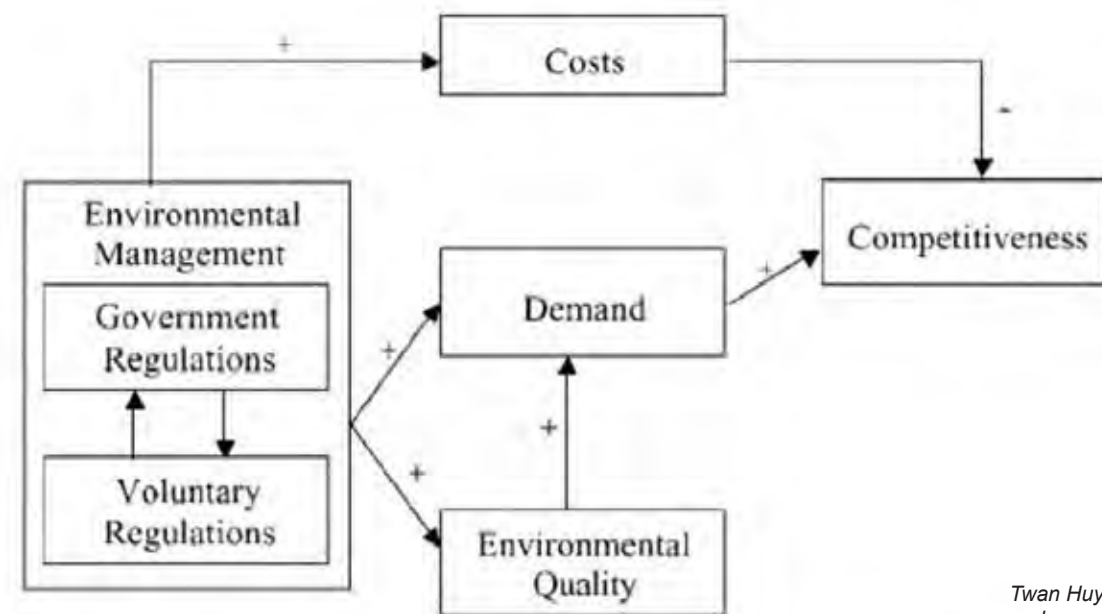
For more detail on the methodology and data sources please refer to the Technical Report at www.griffith.edu.au/griffith-institute-tourism

Environmental Management and Nature-Based Tourist Destinations

Environmental management is the process of planning, implementing, and monitoring the activities of an organization or society to ensure that they are sustainable and do not harm the environment. In recent years, there has been a growing recognition of the importance of environmental management in the tourism industry, particularly in nature-based tourism destinations. This is because such destinations rely heavily on the natural environment for their attractiveness, and any harm to the environment can have a significant impact on the tourism industry and the local economy.

Nature-based tourism destinations are those that attract visitors because of their natural beauty or wildlife, such as national parks, beaches, forests, and wildlife reserves. These destinations are often located in remote or fragile ecosystems and are particularly vulnerable to the negative impacts of tourism, such as pollution, habitat destruction, and the overuse of natural resources. Therefore, effective environmental management is essential to ensure the sustainability of nature-based tourism destinations.

One of the main benefits of environmental management in nature-based tourism destinations is that it can enhance the competitiveness of these destinations. Tourists are increasingly aware of the environmental impacts of their travel choices and are seeking destinations that are committed to sustainability. By implementing effective environmental management practices, nature-based tourism destinations can differentiate themselves from competitors and attract more environmentally conscious tourists.



Twan Huybers & Jeff Bennett's study shows how regulations can improve the tourism especially nature-based tourism

Source: Environmental management and competitiveness of nature based tourism destinations

One way that environmental management can enhance the competitiveness of nature-based tourism destinations is by improving the quality of the visitor experience. A pristine natural environment is often the main attraction for tourists visiting nature-based destinations. If this environment is degraded by pollution or other environmental impacts, the visitor experience is likely to be diminished. By implementing effective environmental management practices, such as waste reduction and pollution prevention, nature-based tourism destinations can maintain the quality of their natural environment and ensure a positive visitor experience.

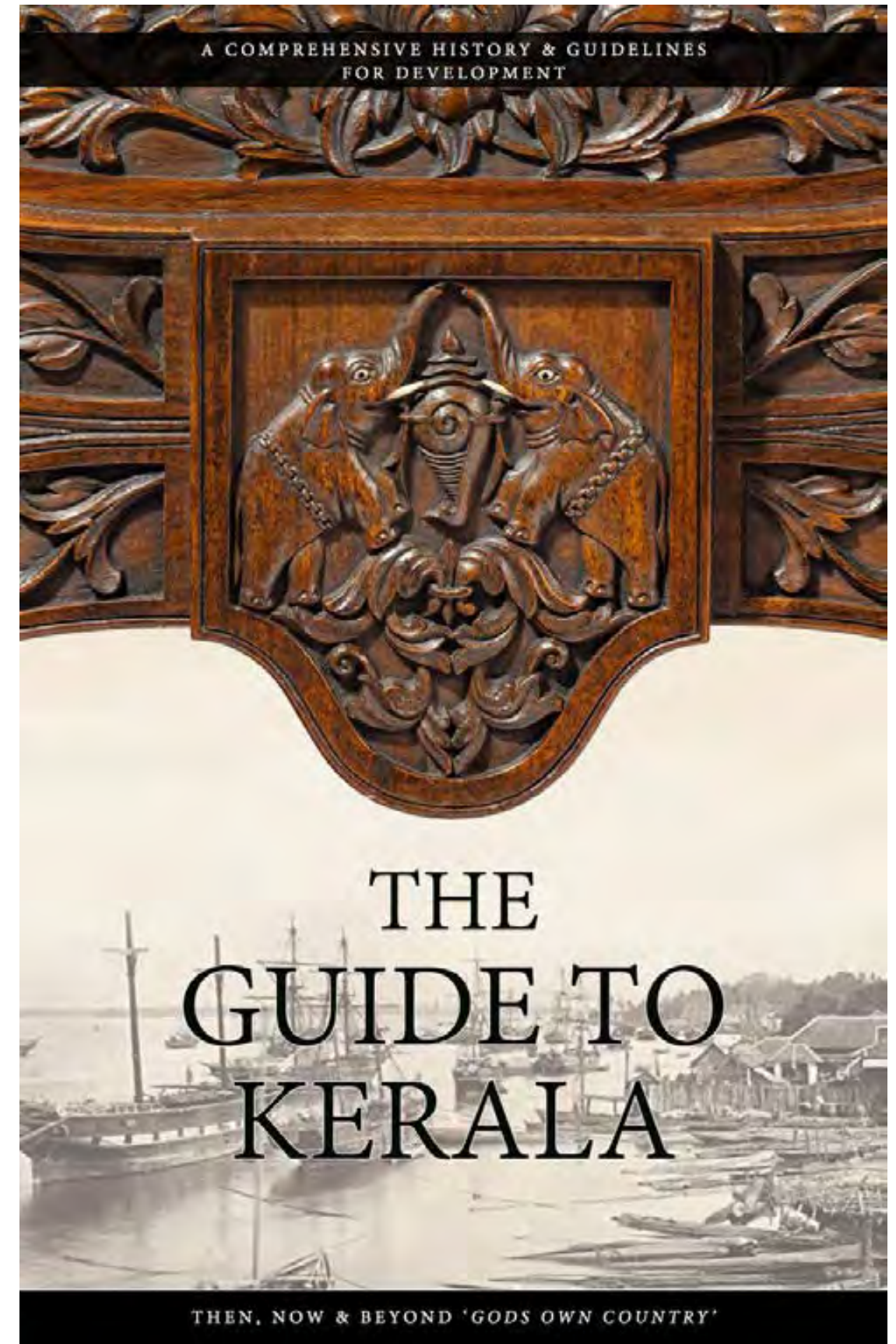
Another way that environmental management can enhance the competitiveness of nature-based tourism destinations is by reducing costs and improving efficiency. Sustainable practices such as energy and water conservation can reduce operating costs for tourism businesses, while also reducing the environmental footprint of the destination. This can lead to cost savings for tourism businesses, which can be passed on to visitors in the form of lower prices or better services. In addition, sustainable practices can improve the efficiency of tourism operations, which can enhance the overall visitor experience and attract more tourists to the destination.

Effective environmental management in nature-based tourism destinations requires collaboration between stakeholders, including tourism businesses, government agencies, local communities, and conservation organizations. Stakeholders must work together to develop and implement sustainable practices that meet the needs of both the tourism industry and the environment. This collaboration can lead to a shared sense of responsibility for the sustainability of the destination, which can enhance the competitiveness of the destination in the long term.

Environmental management is essential for the sustainability of nature-based tourism destinations. By implementing effective environmental management practices, these destinations can enhance their competitiveness by improving the quality of the visitor experience, reducing costs and improving efficiency, and attracting more environmentally conscious tourists. However, achieving sustainable tourism in nature-based destinations requires collaboration and cooperation between stakeholders, and a commitment to balancing the needs of the tourism industry with the protection of the natural environment.

*Beautiful landscape of tea plantations on the hills of
Munnar, Kerala*
Source: Image by Bobby James from Pixabay

Tourist Map /Guide to Kerala & Types of Tourism in Kerala/ Development Guidelines



*An illustration of the proposed cover page for the book
The Guide to Kerala*

Kerala, located in the southwestern region of India, is a land of diverse natural and cultural beauty that has made it a popular tourist destination. The state boasts of a wide variety of tourism options ranging from backwaters, beaches, hills, cultural heritage, art and architecture, and medical tourism. In this essay, we will discuss the various types of tourism in Kerala and their potential, as well as tourists' arrival statistics.



An everyday view during the months of April, May before monsoons in the beautiful backwaters of Alappuzha, Kerala

TYPES OF TOURISM IN KERALA

Backwater Tourism



Culture Tourism



History, Art & Architecture



Beach Tourism



Medical Tourism



Hill station

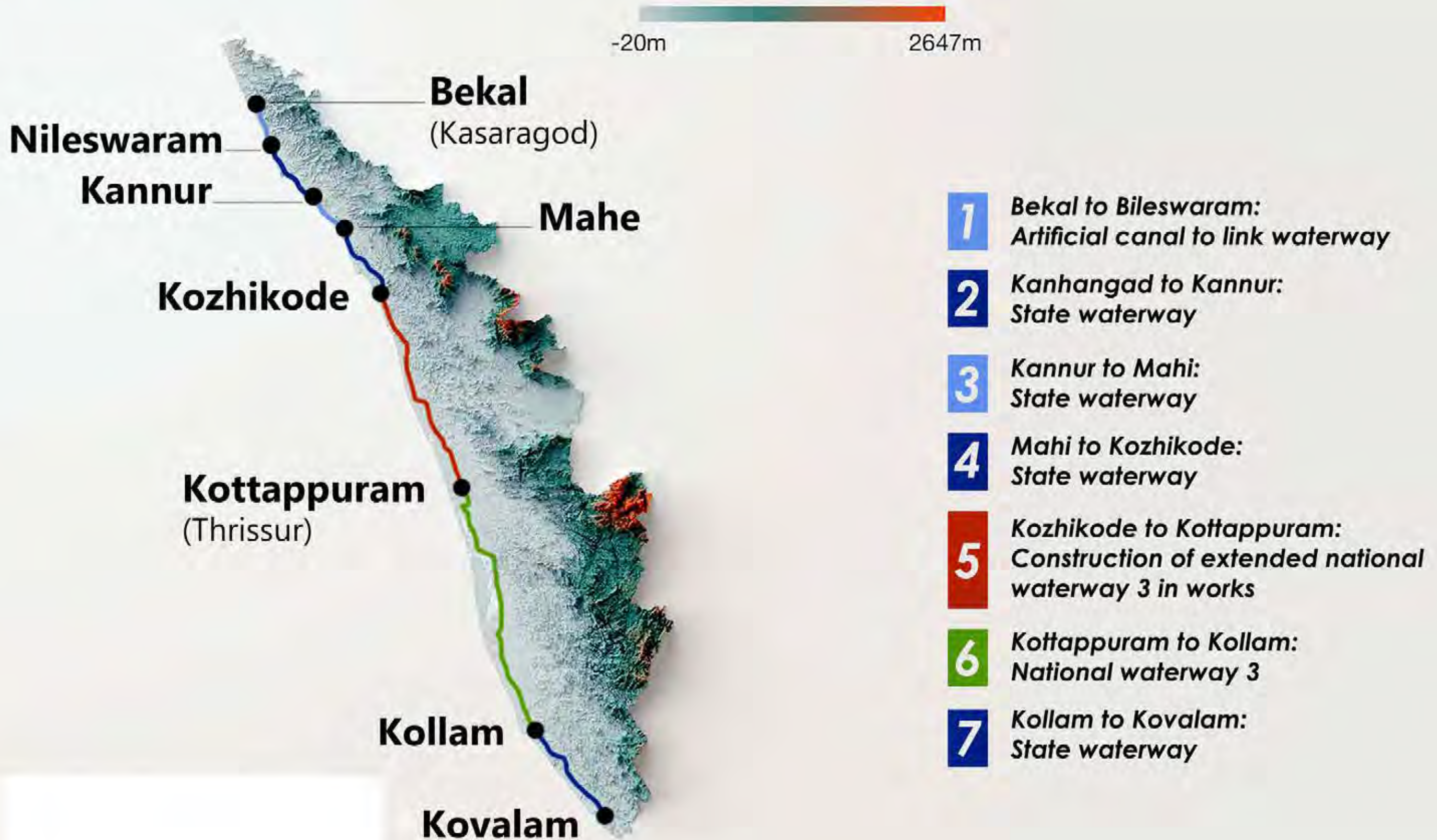


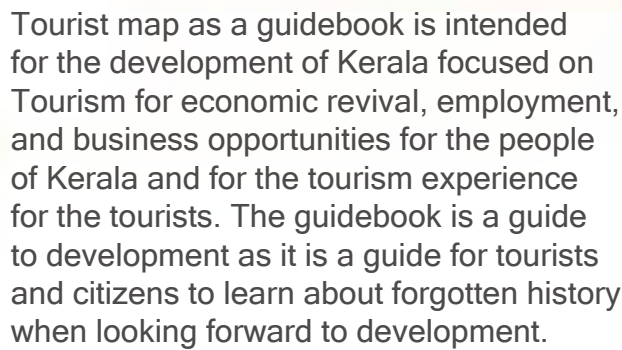
The major types of tourism in Kerala are Backwater Tourism, Culture Tourism, History, Art & Architecture Tourism, Beach Tourism, Medical Tourism and Hill Station Tourism. Now the aim is not to find more tourist types or places but to improve the current Tourist Places with more infrastructure attractions and basic needs to sustainable



14 DISTRICTS													
Kasaragod	Kannur	Wayanad	Kozhikode	Malappuram	Palakkad	Thrissur	Ernakulam	Idukki	Kottayam	Alappuzha	Pathanamthitta	Kollam	Thiruvananthapuram
Bekal Fort	St. Angelo Fort	Edakkal Caves	Kozhikode Beach	Idukki Arch Dam	Palakkad Fort	Pennathur Kotta	Ernakulam Museum	Idukki Arch Dam	Idukki Arch Dam	Alappuzha Beach	Gavi	Ashtamudi Lake	Kuthirama Palace Museum
Ranipitram Hill Station	Muzhappilangad Beach	Kuruvu Island	Kadambur Fort Sanctuary	Biyyam Kayal	Vadakkannur Temple	Shakthan Thampuran Palace	Santhi Palace Museum	Kavayitranthi Mahila Mandir	Vakkam	Krishnapuram Palace	Thiruvananthapuram	Thangassery Light House	Padmanabhapuram Palace
Parappal Wildlife Sanctuary	Palakkayam Thottu	Chembra Peak	Valayana Devi Temple	Mamburam	Palakkad Fort	Muzhappilangad Beach	Wonderla Amusement Park	Kavayitranthi Mahila Mandir	Ilaveezha Poonchira	Marari Beach	Mulloor Smarakam	Kollam Beach	Nagpur Museum
Thakadappuram Beach	Kannur Light House	Banasura Sagar Dam	Thalikkunnu Shiva Temple	Anmolgha Hills	Malappuram Garden & Dam	Chuvakkad Beach	Kashi Art Gallery	Thiruvananthapuram	Tomb of Saint Alphonsa	Vembanad Lake	Manjikkara Church	Thirumullavaram Beach	The Kanakakunnu Palace
Malom Wildlife Sanctuary	Vismaya Water Park	Pookode Lake	Beyyore Beach	Pazhayangudi Mosque	Jain Temple	Dolours Basilica	Cherai Beach	Vandanmeda	Nadukani	Mary Forane Church	Sabarimala	Kollam Adventure Park	Priyadarshini Space Planetarium
Malikarjuna Temple	Peyyambalam Beach	Neelimala View Point	Srikantheshwara Temple	Padinharekara Beach	Rock Garden	Thrissur Zoo and State Museum	Fort Kochi & Matancherry	Palnattu	Pathiramanal	Mullakkal Rajarajeswari Temple	Paliakara Church	Anandavallewaram Temple	Vizhinjam Rock Cut Cave
Hosdurg Fort	Madayipara Village	Meyyathottam Waterfalls	Kakkayam Dam	Kodikkuthimala	Swati Valley National Park	Chattuvu Backwater	Chottanikkara Temple	Thiruvananthapuram	Vigamam	Kuttanad	Paluvu Falls	Thiruvananthapuram Zoo	Thiruvananthapuram Zoo
Chandragiri Fort	Palthamala	Thiruvananthapuram	Saravaram Bio Park	Bharathapuzha River	Attappadi	Paramakkavu Bhagavathy Temple	Paradesi Synagogue	Pothamedu Plantations	Mammala Waterfalls	Triveni Floating Market	Thevalay Palace	Padmanabhaswamy Temple	Padmanabhaswamy Temple
Valliyaparamba Backwaters	Mapilla Bay	Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary	Malabar Botanical Garden	Kovilakom	Kollengode Palace	Kerala Kalamandalam	Marine Drive	Malankara Dargah	St. Mary's Orthodox Church	Backwaters of Alleppey	St. Thomas Fort	Kovalam Beach	Kovalam Beach
Nileshwar Village	Peralassery Stepwell	Jain Temple	Regional Science Centre And Planetarium	Nedumkayam	Nediyampathy	Vadakkumkal Temple	David Hall Gallery & Cafe	Ramakalmeda	Kumarakom Bird Sanctuary	Karumadi	Chinnakada Clock Tower	Shangumukham Beach	Shangumukham Beach
	Erthimla	Phantom Rock	Pazhassiraja Archaeological Museum	Shanthitheeram Park		Vadakkumkannan Temple	Marancherry Palace	Kulamavu Dam	Ilikkal Kallu		Shanthitheeram Park	Neyyar Dam and Wildlife Sanctuary	Neyyar Dam and Wildlife Sanctuary
	Dharmadam Island	Pakkilathottam Bird Sanctuary				Guruvayur Sree Krishna Temple	Chinese Fishing Nets	Mangala Devi Temple	Thangal Para			Vell Thiruvil Village	Vell Thiruvil Village
	Tellicherry Fort	Pazhassi Raja Tomb					Jew Town	Nedumkandam Hills	Kumaranalloor Bhagavathy Temple			Ponmudi	Ponmudi
	Pennarakkudam Snake Park	Pallikkunnu Church					Cricket Stadium		Thazhathangadi			Pogovar Island	Pogovar Island
	Aradim Wildlife Sanctuary	Krishnapuram Cricket Stadium										Agasthyakoodam	Agasthyakoodam
	Arakkal Museum	Karapuzha Dam										Cricket Stadium	Cricket Stadium
	Thottada Beach	Varambetta Mosque											
	Kannur Beach												
Access													
Airport													
Waterway													
Road													
TYPE OF TOURISMS IN KERALA													
LEGEND	BACKWATER	BEACH	FORT & PALACES/HISTORY	PARK/HILL STATIONS/FOREST/ISLAND	MONUMENTS/RELIGIOUS	MUSEUMS/PERFORMING ARTS	WILDLIFE	NATURAL/WATERFALL	COMMERCIAL	ARCHITECTURE/SETTLEMENT/VILLAGE	CIVIL INFRASTRUCTURE		

The chart illustrates a selection of major tourist destinations across the districts of the State of Kerala to identify in the development of the proposal of the Tourist Map





The diagram illustrates the proposed rail network in Kerala, India, showing a central vertical rail line with various cities and international airports connected by branches. Distances are marked in kilometers (km).

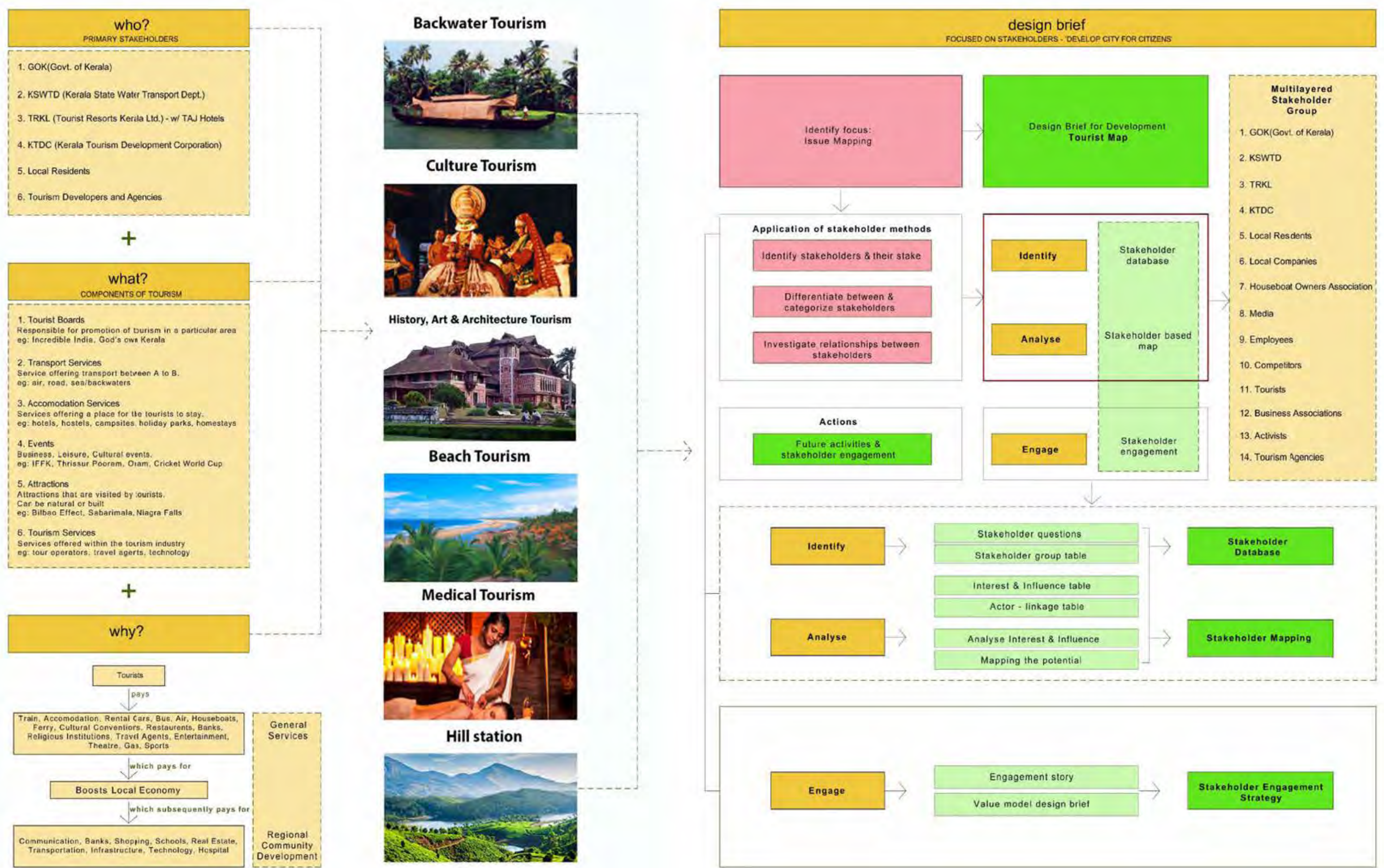
Central Rail Line (Top to Bottom):

- Kasaragod city
- 90 km
- Kannur City
- 90 km
- Kozhikode city
- 30 km
- 25 km
- Malappuram city
- 80 km
- 80 km
- Trissur city
- 75 km
- Ernakulam city
- 60 km
- Alappuzha city
- 85 km
- Kollam city
- 65 km
- Thiruvananthapuram city
- 7 km

Branches and Connections:

- Kannur City to Kannur International Airport (CNN):** 28 km
- Kannur International Airport (CNN) to Kalpetta (Wayanad):** 100 km
- Kozhikode city to Kalpetta (Wayanad):** 70 km
- Kozhikode city to Kozhikode International Airport (CCJ):** 85 km
- Malappuram city to Palakkad city:** 80 km
- Trissur city to Palakkad city:** 70 km
- Ernakulam city to Cochin International Airport (COK):** 28 km
- Ernakulam city to Kottayam city:** 65 km
- Alappuzha city to Kottayam city:** 45 km
- Kottayam city to Pattanamthitta city:** 95 km
- Kollam city to Pattanamthitta city:** 60 km
- Thiruvananthapuram city to Thiruvananthapuram International Airport (TRV):** 7 km

Stakeholder Diagram



Kerala is home to a vast network of interconnected canals, lagoons, and lakes, known as the backwaters. These backwaters are a unique ecosystem that supports a variety of flora and fauna, including a large number of migratory birds. Tourists can explore the backwaters on houseboats, which offer a relaxing and comfortable way to experience the natural beauty of the backwaters. The backwaters of Kerala are one of the most popular tourist destinations in the state, attracting around 2 million visitors annually.

Kerala Backwater Tourism

*A Houseboat cruising through the beautiful
backwaters of Alappuzha, Kerala*

What are Backwaters, Kerala most famous for?



The Kerala backwaters are a network of brackish lagoons and lakes lying parallel to the Arabian Sea coast of Kerala state in southern India, as well as interconnected canals, rivers, and inlets, a labyrinthine system formed by more than 900 kilometres (560 mi) of waterways, and sometimes compared to American bayous.

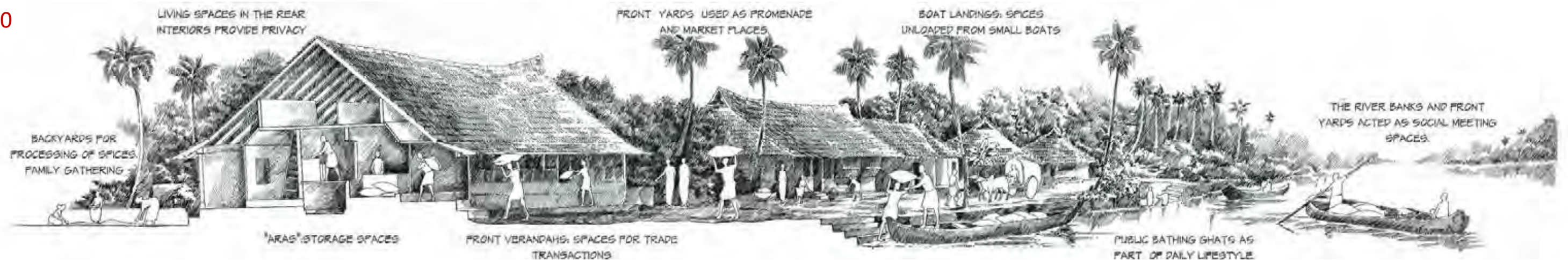


The West Coast Canal or National Waterway No 3 is a 205 km (127 mi) long inland navigational route located in Kerala, India, which runs from Kollam to Kottapuram. It was declared a National Waterway in 1993.

Backwater network and allied activities and means of livelihood

Backwater based daily life

1760



2020



Houseboat cruise in backwaters



Fishing nets in backwaters



Backwater based developments



Paddy activity

The life of backwater based communities has undergone significant changes from the 17th century to the 21st century. Backwaters are a network of interconnected lagoons and lakes lying parallel to the Arabian Sea coast of Kerala, India. These water bodies are a significant part of the state's ecosystem and are home to a diverse range of flora and fauna. The backwaters have played a vital role in shaping the social, economic, and cultural aspects of the communities that live in and around them.

In the 17th century, backwater based communities were primarily involved in agriculture and fishing. The economy was largely subsistence-based, and people depended on natural resources for their livelihoods. The waterways were used mainly for transportation of goods and people. The local communities had developed a system of canal-based navigation that was efficient and sustainable. The waterways were also used for irrigation and flood control. The backwaters were an essential source of freshwater, and communities depended on them for drinking and household purposes.

During the colonial period, the British established trade links with Kerala, which led to the development of the port of Cochin. The port became an important hub for trade, and the backwaters played a vital role in the transportation of goods. The British also introduced modern methods of agriculture, which led to the

cultivation of cash crops such as rubber and tea. The introduction of cash crops and modern agricultural practices led to a shift from subsistence-based agriculture to a more commercialized form of farming. This shift led to a transformation of the local economy, and people became more dependent on cash-based transactions.

In the 20th century, the backwaters became a significant tourist destination. The state government recognized the potential of the backwaters as a tourist attraction and started developing the infrastructure required to support tourism. The government initiated several projects, including the construction of resorts, houseboats, and tourist centers, to attract visitors to the backwaters. The development of tourism led to the creation of new job opportunities and helped to boost the local economy.

Backwater tourism has had both positive and negative impacts on the people of backwater-based communities. On the positive side, tourism has provided new job opportunities for local people. Houseboats, resorts, and tourist centers require a significant workforce, and this has led to the creation of jobs in the tourism sector. The tourism industry has also led to the development of small businesses such as shops, restaurants, and handicrafts, which provide additional employment opportunities.

The influx of tourists has also led to an increase in the demand for local products, such as coir products, spices, and handicrafts. This has provided new markets for local businesses, which has helped to diversify the local economy. The increased economic activity has led to improvements in infrastructure such as roads, electricity, and water supply, which has benefited the local communities.

On the negative side, the development of tourism has led to environmental degradation. The construction of resorts, houseboats, and tourist centers has led to the destruction of mangrove forests and wetlands. The increased traffic of houseboats and motorboats has led to water pollution and erosion of riverbanks.

The influx of tourists has also led to the depletion of natural resources, such as freshwater and fish stocks.

Tourism has also led to a change in the traditional way of life of the local communities. The focus on tourism has led to a decline in agriculture and fishing, which were the mainstays of the local economy. The younger generation has been attracted to the tourism sector, leading to a brain drain in traditional occupations. The influx of tourists has also led to changes in the social fabric of the communities, with traditional values being eroded.



A Houseboat cruising through the beautiful backwaters of Alappuzha, Kerala

Issue Mapping

Need footpaths,
year-round
income from
tourism

Need for clean
drinking water,
proper drainage &
sanitation!
Need for better

Need job security.
Save ecology! Stop
landfilling!

Bike lane &
pedestrian
friendly roads

Finishing point to
develop as a boat
terminal

Need an integrated centre for
tourism that can provide jobs, is
an information centre

Need integrated
connectivity
between land, water
& air

New
infrastructure
and design
programs

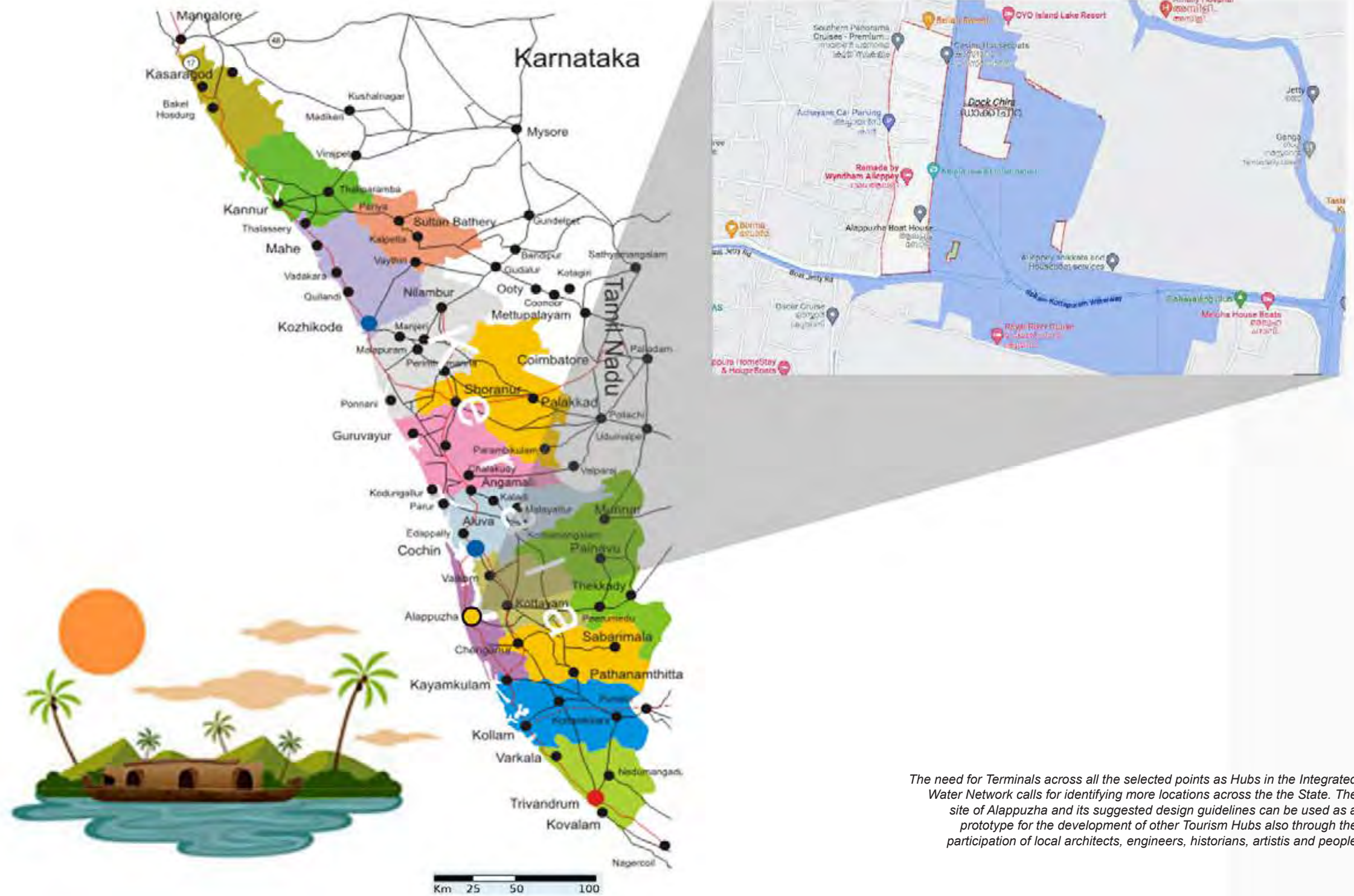
Water transportation
other than tourist
houseboats - more
jobs

Backwater
adjacent
house
based
commerce
and food
tourism



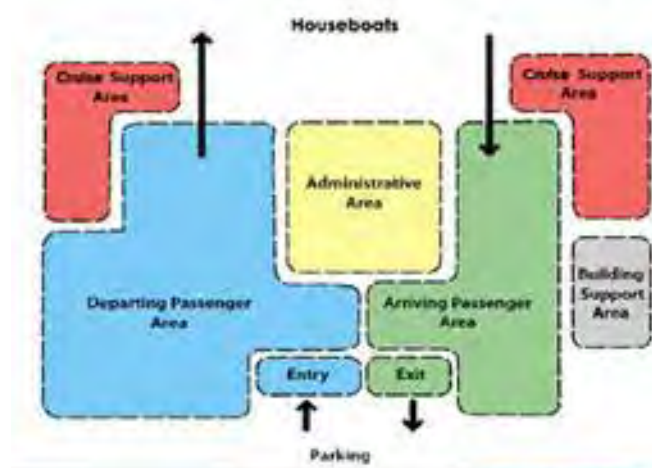
Site for Backwater Tourism Hub

The site selected for focused development is the Alappuzha Finishing Point that currently serves as the Houseboat Tourist Centre. The need for a new Houseboat Terminal is the excellent opportunity to develop the site not just as a Terminal but also a Tourism Hub with resorts, Hands-on experience centres, Exhibition Centres, Education Theatres, Performing Arts Spaces and Houseboat Terminal. This Hub should be a model for a series of Hubs that should be developed as median centres in the Tourist Map.



The need for Terminals across all the selected points as Hubs in the Integrated Water Network calls for identifying more locations across the the State. The site of Alappuzha and its suggested design guidelines can be used as a prototype for the development of other Tourism Hubs also through the participation of local architects, engineers, historians, artists and people

Current Scenario



Need for a Bilbao effect



Houseboat Tourism Hubs



Walk friendly terminal spaces and tourism



Design Interventions

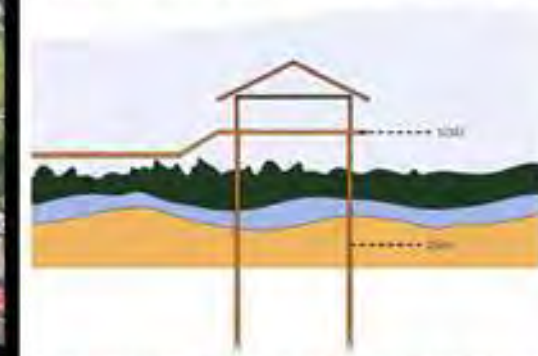
1. To identify most marshy areas where land filling is not economically viable and ecologically feasible and piled to do construction



2. Minimum land filling in site - Paths and Decks



3. 90 cm c/c - coconut piling with minimum land filling for single story buildings or open structures. For larger structures - raised decks and platforms on piles and construction of structures



4. Bamboo skin over steel frames can be an ideal solution for light weight and durable construction requirement



The need to include local context into consideration such as the ecology to develop design interventions that accomodates the traditional architecture to solve modern needs would be the most ideal solution. This would require the participation of the architects, designers and thinkers from the region to reciprocate to the needs.

The current scenario of the Finishing Point Houseboat Terminal is in a dilapidated state. The tourism factor of the design is not considered in most of the infrastructural developments in the current scenario. This needs to change. The need to include expert architects from local context and artists and inclusion of historians in the design phase to develop a true-to-context design that genuinely reflects the architecture of the space is of utmost need.

Develop Backwater Tourism in Kerala

Backwater tourism is a major tourist attraction in Kerala, and it has great potential for further development. Here are some steps that can be taken to develop backwater tourism in Kerala:

Improve Infrastructure: The first step towards developing backwater tourism in Kerala is to improve the infrastructure. This includes developing proper transportation, communication, and accommodation facilities, as well as ensuring that the waterways are well-maintained and safe for tourists to use.

Promote the Destination: Kerala has a unique advantage when it comes to backwater tourism. The state government can work on promoting the destination and creating awareness about the experiences that tourists can have here. This can be done through targeted marketing campaigns, roadshows, and collaborations with travel agents and tour operators.

Encourage Local Participation: Backwater tourism can be a great source of income for local communities. The state government can encourage local participation by involving them in the tourism industry. This can be done through training programs, skill development initiatives, and by creating job opportunities.

Sustainable Tourism: It is important to ensure that backwater tourism is sustainable and does not harm the environment. The state government can work on developing eco-friendly practices and promoting responsible tourism. This can include waste management, water conservation, and the conservation of local flora and fauna.

Diversify the Offerings: While backwater tourism is a major attraction, the state can diversify its offerings to cater to a wider range of tourists. This can include adventure activities like kayaking and canoeing, cultural tours, and food tours.

By taking these steps, the state government can develop backwater tourism in Kerala and create a sustainable tourism industry that benefits both tourists and locals.

A local manually rowed boat with passengers traveling from one island to other in the backwaters of Kerala in dusk

Kerala Cultural Tourism

Kerala has a rich cultural heritage that is reflected in its art, music, dance, and architecture. The state is home to numerous temples, churches, and other cultural landmarks, which are popular tourist attractions. Cultural tourism in Kerala also includes Ayurveda, the ancient Indian system of medicine, which has gained popularity among tourists seeking alternative treatments for various ailments. Kerala's rich cultural heritage makes it a popular destination for tourists seeking a deeper understanding of India's history and culture. The state attracts around 1.5 million cultural tourists



A Theyyam artist with his makeup

The great stories of Kerala are often retold using art forms. It is here that our legends truly come to life. Theyyam is a famous ritual art form that originated in North Kerala which brings to life the great stories of our State. It encompasses dance, mime and music. It exalts the beliefs of the ancient tribals who gave a lot of importance to the worship of heroes and the spirits of their ancestors. The ceremonious dance is accompanied by the chorus of such musical instruments as Chenda, Elathalam, Kurumkuzal and Veekkuchenda. There are over 400 separate Theyyams, each with their own music, style and choreography.

Why is Kerala famous for Cultural Tourism?

The main USP of Kerala is its performing arts like Kathakali, Mohiniyattam and Martial Art of Kalaripayattu. As for the heritage of Kerala, it can be said that this heritage holds a special and important place in the Indian history.



Kadhakali performance

Kadhakali combines devotion, drama, dance, music, costumes and make up into a divine experience for all who get to view it. It retells the great stories of the past, mostly from Indian epics, and leaves one spellbound at the various intricacies involved in the performance.

Kerala, is known for its diverse cultural heritage and natural beauty, which attracts a large number of tourists every year. While cultural tourism in Kerala has immense potential to contribute to the state's economy and socio-cultural development, it also faces several challenges and issues that need to be addressed.

Some of these issues and challenges are:

Commercialization of culture: One of the biggest challenges of cultural tourism in Kerala is the commercialization of culture. The commodification of cultural practices and traditions can lead to the loss of their authenticity and significance, and may even result in the exploitation of local communities.

Lack of infrastructure: The lack of adequate infrastructure, such as transportation, accommodation, and sanitation facilities, can hinder the growth of cultural tourism in Kerala. This can also impact the visitor experience and discourage tourists from visiting the state.

Sustainability: The sustainability of cultural tourism in Kerala is a crucial issue. Unregulated and unsustainable tourism practices can harm the environment, the local communities, and their cultural heritage. It is important to promote responsible tourism practices that ensure the preservation of the state's cultural and natural resources.

Lack of marketing and promotion: Despite its cultural richness and diverse tourism offerings, Kerala's cultural tourism industry has not received adequate marketing and promotion, which limits its reach and potential. Effective marketing and promotion strategies are necessary to create awareness and attract tourists to the state.

Conflict with conservation efforts: Cultural tourism in Kerala can sometimes conflict with conservation efforts to protect wildlife and natural habitats. The development of tourism infrastructure can impact the delicate balance between humans and wildlife and threaten the survival of some endangered species.

Preservation of cultural heritage: The preservation of cultural heritage sites and traditions is essential to maintain their authenticity and significance. Neglect, improper maintenance, and lack of funding can result in the decay and loss of cultural heritage sites and practices, which can adversely affect cultural tourism in Kerala.

Addressing these issues and challenges is crucial to ensure the sustainable growth and development of cultural tourism in Kerala while preserving its cultural and natural resources.

Issue Mapping



Commercialization of culture: Loss of their authenticity and significance, and may even result in the exploitation of local communities



Unregulated and unsustainable tourism practices can harm the environment, the local communities, and their cultural heritage



The lack of adequate infrastructure, such as transportation, accommodation, and sanitation facilities



Lack of marketing and promotion



Preservation of cultural heritage sites and



Conflict with conservation efforts to protect wildlife and natural habitats



KERALA BROADWAY IN CHICAGO



The idea is to provide an upgrade to the temporary events and festivals as of today where Kadhakali, Kalaripayattu, Koodiyattam, Theyyam and to incorporate them as alternating shows in theatres in different seasons



Develop Cultural Tourism in Kerala

Kerala is a state in India that is rich in cultural heritage, natural beauty, and traditional practices. Developing cultural tourism in Kerala can be a great way to showcase its unique identity to the world and generate economic benefits for the local community. Some suggestions on how to develop cultural tourism in Kerala:

Promote local festivals and events: Kerala is known for its vibrant festivals and events, such as Onam, Vishu, Thrissur Pooram, and the Nehru Trophy Boat Race. By promoting and marketing these events to tourists, Kerala can attract visitors who are interested in experiencing its cultural traditions.

Develop cultural trails and heritage walks: Kerala has a rich history and cultural heritage that can be explored through walking tours and cultural trails. By creating well-marked routes and providing visitors with information about local history and traditions, cultural tourism can be promoted.

Encourage homestays and community tourism: Homestays are a great way for tourists to experience local culture and traditions while supporting the local community. By encouraging more homestays and community tourism initiatives, Kerala can provide tourists with an authentic cultural experience while also generating economic benefits for the local community.

Develop cultural centers and museums: Kerala has a rich history and cultural heritage that can be showcased through cultural centers and museums. By creating cultural centers and museums that showcase the state’s unique identity, Kerala can attract visitors who are interested in learning more about its history and traditions.

Offer traditional arts and crafts experiences: Kerala is known for its traditional arts and crafts, such as Kathakali, Mohiniyattam, Kalaripayattu, and handloom weaving. By offering experiences that allow visitors to learn about and participate in these traditional arts and crafts, Kerala can provide a unique and memorable cultural tourism experience.

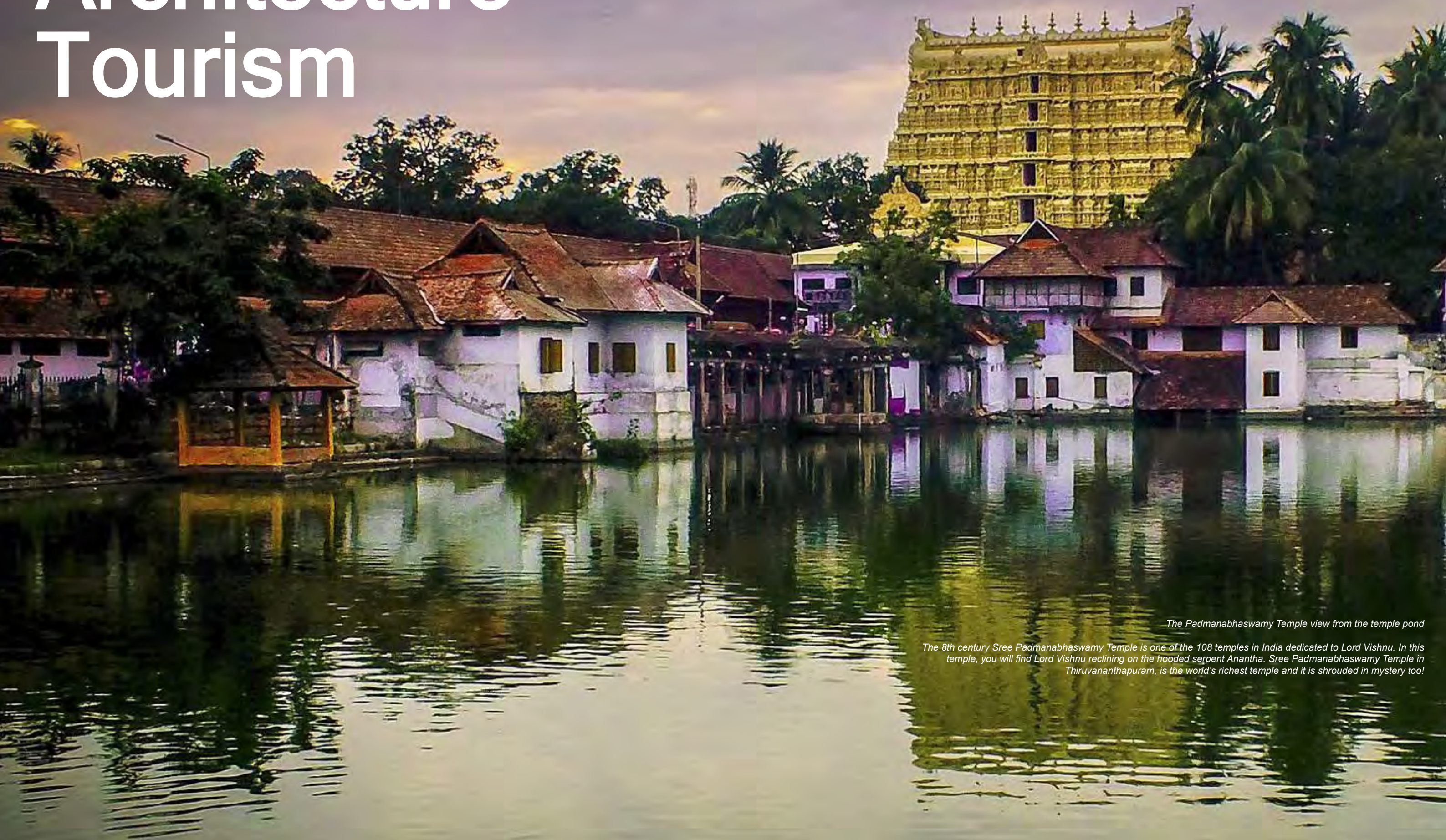
Developing cultural tourism in Kerala requires a concerted effort from the government, local communities, and tourism industry stakeholders. By working together to promote Kerala’s cultural heritage, the state can attract visitors who are interested in experiencing its unique identity and traditions.



A snippet from Kathakali performance

History, Art & Architecture Tourism

Kerala's history can be traced back to the Neolithic period, and the state has a rich tradition of art and architecture that reflects its history and cultural heritage. The state is home to numerous ancient temples, palaces, and other historical landmarks that are popular tourist attractions. The art and architecture of Kerala are unique and have a distinct style that reflects the state's rich cultural heritage. History, art, and architecture tourism in Kerala attracts around 1.2 million visitors annually.



The Padmanabhaswamy Temple view from the temple pond

The 8th century Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple is one of the 108 temples in India dedicated to Lord Vishnu. In this temple, you will find Lord Vishnu reclining on the hooded serpent Anantha. Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple in Thiruvananthapuram, is the world's richest temple and it is shrouded in mystery too!

Kerala has a fascinating history that spans over thousands of years. It was a major center for trade and commerce, attracting travelers and merchants from across the world since ancient times. The region was ruled by various dynasties, including the Cheras, Cholas, and the Zamorins. Kerala also had strong cultural and trade connections with ancient civilizations such as the Greeks, Romans, Arabs, and Chinese, which influenced its history.

Kerala has a vibrant tradition of art forms that are unique to the region. One of the most famous art forms of Kerala is Kathakali, a highly stylized classical dance-drama that combines dance, music, and drama with elaborate makeup and costumes. Other popular art forms include Theyyam, a colorful ritualistic dance-drama performed in temples, Mohiniyattam, a graceful classical dance form, and Kalaripayattu, a martial art form that originated in Kerala and is considered one of the oldest martial arts in the world.

Kerala is known for its distinctive architectural style, which is influenced by its geography, climate, and cultural heritage. One of the most famous examples of Kerala’s architecture is its traditional houses known as Nalukettu. Nalukettu is a type of ancestral house characterized by a central courtyard, surrounded by rooms with intricately carved wooden architecture and a sloping tiled roof. Another famous architectural style is the Malabar style, which features intricately carved wooden facades and elaborate roof structures with sloping roofs.

Kerala’s history, art, and architecture form an integral part of its tourism offerings. History enthusiasts can explore ancient temples, forts, and palaces that showcase the state’s rich heritage. Art lovers can witness traditional art forms being performed by skilled artists in cultural centers and temples. Architecture aficionados can marvel at the unique Nalukettu houses and other traditional buildings that dot the landscape of Kerala.

Some popular historical and architectural attractions in Kerala include the Mattancherry Palace, also known as the Dutch Palace, which features a blend of Dutch and Kerala architectural styles, the Hill Palace Museum, which was the erstwhile residence of the Kochi royal family and showcases their rich history and culture, and the Padmanabhapuram Palace, an ancient wooden palace that is a fine example of traditional Kerala architecture.

Kerala also hosts various art festivals and cultural events throughout the year, such as the Kochi-Muziris Biennale, which is one of the largest contemporary art festivals in Asia, and the Thrissur Pooram, a grand temple festival that features colorful processions, fireworks, and traditional music and dance performances.

Kerala’s history, art, and architecture offer a unique and captivating experience for tourists interested in exploring the rich cultural heritage of the region. With its ancient temples, traditional art forms, and unique architectural styles, Kerala is a treasure trove for history, art, and architecture enthusiasts, making it a must-visit destination for cultural tourism.



Padmanabhapuram Palace

Padmanabhapuram Palace was once the residence of the rulers of the erstwhile princely state of Travancore. This palace complex situated in the state of Tamil Nadu in India, is regarded as Asia’s largest wooden palace, has fourteen structures spread over in an area of six acres

Issue Mapping



Many of the historical sites in Kerala are centuries-old and require constant maintenance and renovation to preserve their cultural significance.



Tourist activities and the development of infrastructure around heritage sites have led to the loss of their authenticity and cultural significance



Lack of awareness and education about Kerala's history, art, and architecture undermines the importance of these sites



Inadequate infrastructure

Uncontrolled tourism activities around historical sites have led to the degradation of natural ecosystems, including forests and water bodies, affecting the cultural significance of the sites.



Environmental degradation



Why Padmanabhaswamy Temple is so famous?

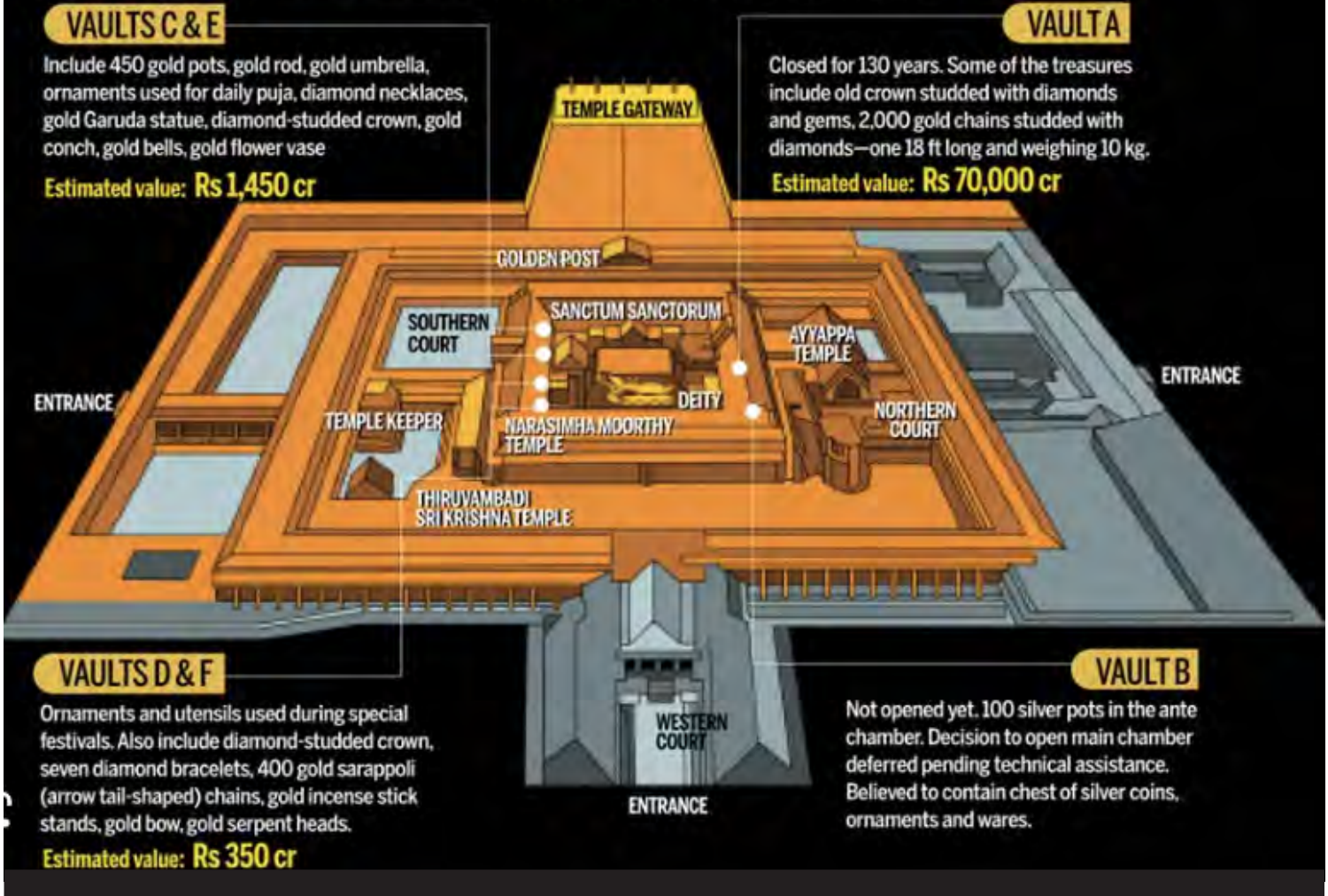
Across the world, the Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple is renowned for its beauty and grandeur. Dedicated to Lord Vishnu, it is one of the 108 sacred Vishnu temples or 'Divya Deshams' in India. Since 2011, when an apex court committee stumbled upon six vaults in the temple and with just vault B left yet to be opened, the treasure that has been found in the five vaults has been estimated to be worth over Rs one lakh crore (1 trillion dollars).



GOLDEN HOARD

Five vaults at Thiruvananthapuram's Sree Padmanabhaswamy Temple have yielded treasures estimated at Rs 1 lakh crore

THE SREE PADAMANABHASWAMY TEMPLE COMPLEX

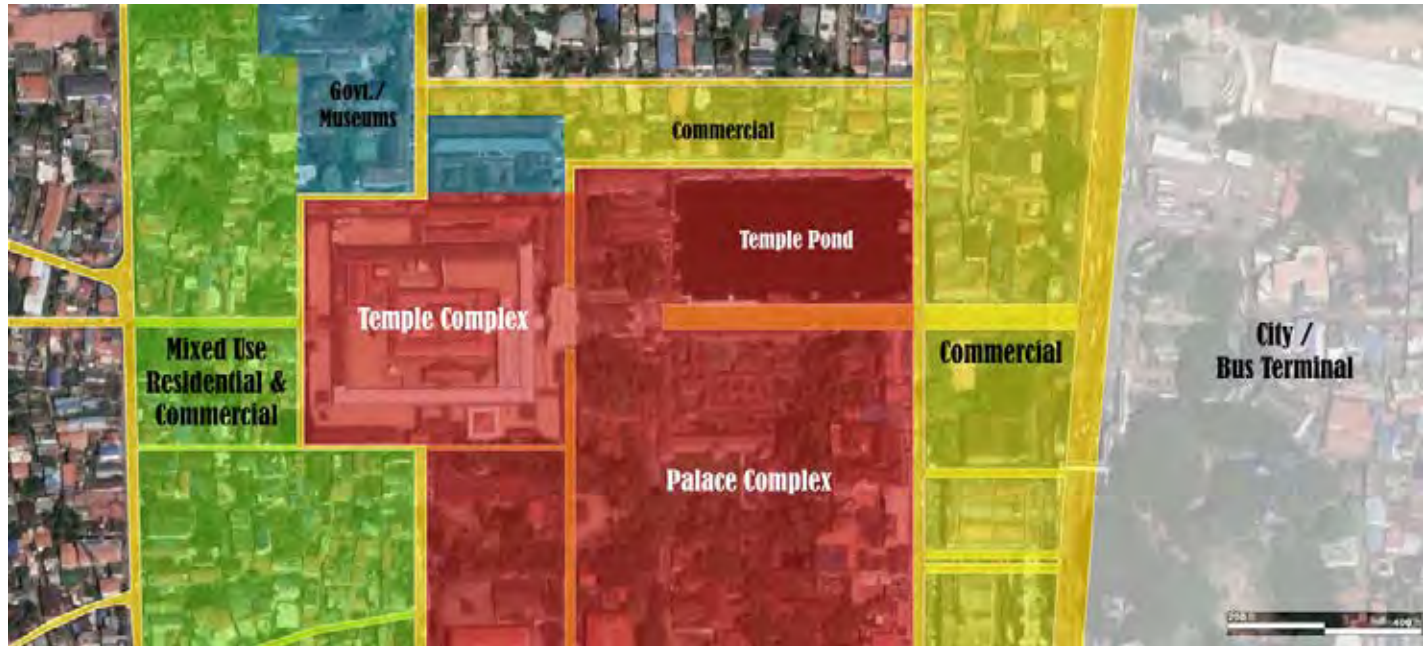




The roads are marked to zone the spaces to identify how to develop the area around the Temple and how it should be developed



The north side commercial areas are zoned as public park to bring in a buffer between the hectic city to the east such that the temple and the palace is prominently placed to not just devotees but also to the general public



Zoning helps to identify areas to be developed considering the heritage value of the site since most of them around the temple are centuries old buildings. However most of them in the commercial zone are not repurposed but is been used as shops that doesn't hold any value to the temple context



Bringing a park as an intervention to the busy city will bring a huge breathing space to the city and the park being in the proximity adjacent to the temple and the palace keeps the sanctity of the temple will bring

Current Scenario



Proposal



New park proposal to bring newer meaning to the context



Pedestrian walk way designed to streamline crowd

One park at a time

Develop History, Art & Architecture Tourism in Kerala

Developing History, Art & Architecture tourism in Kerala would require a comprehensive plan and a coordinated effort between various stakeholders, including the government, private businesses, and local communities.

Here are some steps that could be taken to promote this type of tourism in Kerala:

Preservation of Heritage Sites: Kerala has a rich cultural heritage and numerous historical and architectural sites that need to be preserved and maintained to attract tourists. The government should ensure that these sites are well-preserved, and adequate facilities are available for tourists to visit them.

Promotion and Marketing: The government and private players in the tourism industry should work together to promote and market the history, art, and architecture of Kerala to potential visitors. This can be done through various channels such as social media, travel magazines, and cultural festivals. Tour

Packages and Guides: Tour operators should offer packages that cater to tourists interested in exploring the history, art, and architecture of Kerala. The packages could include visits to historical sites, museums, and art galleries. Local guides with knowledge of the cultural heritage of the state could be employed to provide detailed information to visitors.

Cultural Festivals: Cultural festivals such as the Kochi-Muziris Biennale, the Thrissur Pooram, and the Onam festival can showcase the rich cultural heritage of Kerala and attract tourists interested in art, music, and dance.

Skill Development: Training and skill development programs should be provided to local artisans, craftsmen, and artists to enhance the quality of their work and enable them to showcase their talent to a global audience. This would not only promote the local culture but also create livelihood opportunities for the local communities.

Infrastructure Development: Adequate infrastructure such as roads, transportation, and accommodation should be provided to tourists to ensure a comfortable and hassle-free experience. Developing history, art, and architecture tourism in Kerala would require a long-term plan and a sustained effort by all stakeholders. By promoting and preserving the rich cultural heritage of the state, Kerala can become a premier destination for tourists interested in exploring history, art, and architecture.



Padmanabhapuram Palace

Padmanabhapuram Palace was once the residence of the rulers of the erstwhile princely state of Travancore. This palace complex situated in the state of Tamil Nadu in India, is regarded as Asia's largest wooden palace, has fourteen structures spread over in an area of six acres.

Kerala Beach Tourism

Kerala is blessed with a long coastline of about 580 km, which is dotted with some of the most beautiful beaches in India. The beaches in Kerala offer a perfect blend of sun, sand, and surf, making them popular tourist destinations. Some of the most popular beaches in Kerala include Kovalam, Varkala, and Cherai. Beach tourism in Kerala attracts around 1 million visitors annually.



A view of the beautiful beach in Kerala and the backwaters lying parallel to the beach

Beach tourism in Kerala offers a unique experience with its golden sands, swaying palm trees, and azure waters of the Arabian Sea. The state is known for its diverse range of beaches, each with its own charm and appeal, making it a must-visit destination for beach lovers and travelers seeking relaxation, adventure, and natural beauty.

Kerala boasts of several popular beaches, including Kovalam, Varkala, Cherai, Marari, and Bekal, among others. Kovalam, one of the most famous beaches in Kerala, is a crescent-shaped beach with three adjacent beaches known as Lighthouse Beach, Hawah Beach, and Samudra Beach. It offers excellent opportunities for sunbathing, swimming, and water sports such as surfing, parasailing, and catamaran rides. Varkala, on the other hand, is known for its dramatic cliffs that overlook the Arabian Sea, providing a breathtaking view. It is also famous for its mineral-rich black sand that is believed to have medicinal properties, and tourists can indulge in mineral-rich mud baths and spa treatments.

Cherai, located near Kochi, is a picturesque beach known for its serene atmosphere and calm waters. It is an ideal spot for swimming, boating, and dolphin watching. Marari, nestled amidst coconut groves, is a quiet and secluded beach that offers an escape from the hustle and bustle of city life. It is known for its traditional fishing villages, where tourists can witness the lifestyle of the local fishermen and enjoy fresh seafood. Bekal, located in Kasaragod district, is known for its historic Bekal Fort that overlooks the Arabian Sea. The beach offers panoramic views of the fort and is a popular spot for photography and picnics.

Apart from leisurely activities, beach tourism in Kerala also offers a plethora of adventure sports for adrenaline junkies. Water sports like surfing, kayaking, snorkeling, and scuba diving are popular among tourists. The state also has numerous backwaters and lagoons where tourists can indulge in activities like boating, canoeing, and fishing.

One of the unique features of beach tourism in Kerala is the opportunity to experience Ayurveda, the traditional Indian system of medicine, which is known for its healing properties. Several beach resorts and spas in Kerala offer Ayurvedic treatments and therapies to rejuvenate the mind, body, and soul.

The beaches of Kerala are not just about sun, sand, and sea; they are also home to a diverse ecosystem that includes numerous species of flora and fauna. Beaches like Varkala and Kovalam are known for their unique rock formations, while Bekal is famous for its turtle nesting sites. The beaches of Kerala are also important nesting grounds for several species of migratory birds, making them a paradise for birdwatching enthusiasts.

In addition to natural beauty, beach tourism in Kerala also offers opportunities to explore the local culture and cuisine. The state is known for its rich cultural heritage, and tourists can witness traditional dance forms, music performances, and art and craft demonstrations. The local cuisine, which includes seafood, coconut-based dishes, and traditional vegetarian fare, is a gastronomic delight for food enthusiasts. In conclusion, beach tourism in Kerala offers a unique and memorable experience with its pristine beaches, adventure sports, Ayurvedic treatments, diverse flora and fauna, and rich cultural heritage. Whether it's relaxation, adventure, or exploration, Kerala's beaches have something to offer to every type of traveler. With its natural beauty, cultural richness, and warm hospitality, Kerala is truly a paradise for beach lovers and a must-visit destination for those seeking a rejuvenating beach holiday.



A view of the beautiful Varkala beach in Kerala

Beach tourism in Kerala, India, faces a number of issues and challenges, including:

Environmental degradation: The beaches in Kerala are facing environmental degradation due to pollution caused by littering, improper disposal of waste, and other human activities. This can negatively impact the ecosystem and also affect the tourism industry.

Safety concerns: Tourists are at risk of drowning or other accidents due to strong currents, unpredictable tides, and lack of proper safety measures. Inadequate safety infrastructure and a lack of trained lifeguards can put the safety of tourists at risk.

Infrastructure development: The lack of proper infrastructure and facilities such as public restrooms, changing rooms, shower facilities, and recreational facilities can limit the potential for beach tourism development.

Seasonal fluctuations: Kerala experiences monsoon season, which can affect the availability of water sports and other beach activities, and can also impact the number of tourists visiting the beaches.

Competition from other destinations: Kerala's beach tourism industry faces stiff competition from other popular beach destinations in India, such as Goa, and also from international destinations.

Cultural conflicts: Some traditional fishing communities in Kerala may face conflicts with the tourism industry, particularly in terms of land use and resource allocation.

Overcrowding: During peak tourist seasons, beaches in Kerala can become overcrowded, leading to issues such as littering, traffic congestion, and inadequate facilities.

Addressing these challenges will require a concerted effort from the government, private sector, and local communities to develop sustainable tourism practices that prioritize environmental protection, safety, and infrastructure development, while also promoting local culture and providing a high-quality tourism experience for visitors.



A coastal community and their boats in a beautiful beach in Kerala

Issue Mapping



Inadequate safety infrastructure and a lack of trained lifeguards can put the safety of tourists at risk

The beaches in Kerala are facing environmental degradation due to pollution caused by littering, improper disposal of waste, and other human activities

55,000 kg Plastic Waste Collected from South Kerala Ocean in 2 Years



Inadequate safety infrastructure and a lack of trained lifeguards can put the safety of tourists at risk



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Competition from other destinations, eg: goa



Environmental degradation



During peak tourist seasons, beaches become overcrowded, leading to issues such as littering, traffic congestion, and inadequate facilities.

The site selected for the development of Beach Tourism is the Varkala beach. The idea is to develop the cliff and beach by bringing programs to connect these two together via infrastructure such as restaurants, beachfront seating and hybrid stepped landscape.

cliff

program

beach



Similar Sites



The program should connect the **cliff** and **beach** seamlessly making it one whole **connected structure**.

The Beach Tourism development at Varkala should be considered as a prototype for similar other beaches across the State

Current Scenario



Proposal Illustrations



Tourists sit on the Rome's Spanish Steps in Rome

Cliff & beach to be connected via Programs



Restaurants, Convention Centres



Shacks in Anjuna, Goa

Beachfront Hotels

Develop Beach Tourism in Kerala

Kerala is known for its beautiful beaches and scenic coastline, and developing beach tourism can be a great way to boost the state's tourism industry.

Some suggestions for developing beach tourism in Kerala:

Infrastructure development: Developing infrastructure such as roads, public restrooms, beachfront restaurants and cafes, and parking areas can make beaches more accessible and comfortable for tourists.

Promoting eco-tourism: Kerala has a diverse range of ecosystems and biodiversity along its coastline, and promoting eco-tourism can help preserve these unique environments while providing a unique experience for tourists.

Offering water sports: Offering water sports such as surfing, kayaking, and snorkeling can attract adventure seekers and water sport enthusiasts to Kerala's beaches.

Developing beach resorts: Developing beach resorts can provide tourists with comfortable and convenient accommodation options while also providing employment opportunities for locals.

Marketing and promotion: Promoting Kerala's beaches through social media, travel blogs, and travel shows can help attract tourists from both domestic and international markets.

Providing safety measures: Providing lifeguards, signage, and other safety measures can help ensure the safety of tourists while enjoying the beaches.

Community involvement: Involving local communities in the development and management of beach tourism can help ensure the sustainability of the tourism industry while also providing economic benefits to the local population.

Developing beach tourism in Kerala will require a comprehensive approach that considers the needs and interests of both tourists and locals, while also preserving the natural environment and cultural heritage of the region.

Medical Tourism in Kerala

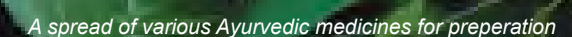
Kerala is fast emerging as a popular destination for medical tourism, with an increasing number of tourists coming to the state to avail of high-quality healthcare services at affordable prices. Kerala is known for its traditional Ayurvedic treatments, which are becoming increasingly popular among tourists seeking alternative treatments for various ailments. The state also has several modern hospitals and healthcare facilities that offer world-class medical care. Medical tourism in Kerala attracts around 500,000 visitors annually.



An Ayurvedic massage as part of the treatment in a spa in Kerala

In addition to cost savings, medical tourists are drawn to Kerala for its highly skilled and experienced medical professionals. Many doctors and surgeons in Kerala have received their medical education and training from reputed international institutions and are known for their expertise and proficiency in their respective fields. The hospitals in Kerala are equipped with state-of-the-art infrastructure and cutting-edge medical technology, ensuring that patients receive top-notch medical care.

Medical tourism in Kerala has gained significant momentum in recent years, owing to its cost-effective healthcare, world-class medical facilities, experienced medical professionals, traditional healing practices, natural beauty, and supportive government policies. With its unique blend of modern medicine and traditional healing practices, Kerala offers a holistic approach to healthcare that attracts international patients seeking high-quality medical treatments at affordable prices in a serene and rejuvenating environment.



Medical Tourism is the Mother Of Tourism

(365 days of Tourism without seasons)

Kerala is fast emerging as a popular destination for medical tourism, with an increasing number of tourists coming to the state to avail of high-quality healthcare services at affordable prices. Kerala is known for its traditional Ayurvedic treatments, which are becoming increasingly popular among tourists seeking alternative treatments for various ailments. The state also has several modern hospitals and healthcare facilities that offer world-class medical care. Medical tourism in Kerala attracts around 500,000 visitors annually.

5L | No. of foreign patients who arrive in India annually seeking medical treatment

\$3bn | Size of medical travel market in India in 2015. Estimated to grow to \$9bn by 2020

25-30% share of medical tourism in earnings for major hospitals in Kochi

25-30% | Growth in the sector annually

WHO COMES TO KOCHI?

- Sri Lanka, Mauritius and Maldives accounted for a major chunk of medical tourists to state
- Now, patients from Gulf countries, Afghanistan, Africa, Nepal, Bhutan and Bangladesh too frequent Kerala for treatment

WHY DO THEY COME HERE FOR?

Medical treatment
Curative treatment like cardiac surgery, organ transplant, neurology, oncology and orthopaedics

Wellness and Rejuvenation | Cosmetic surgery, stress relief, spa, etc

Alternative medicine | Ayurveda, yoga, etc

- Dental treatment

WHAT WORKS IN KOCHI'S FAVOUR

- Availability of experienced doctors
- Cost of treatment in hospitals is almost 25 % cheaper than that in other states, like say Bengaluru, Mumbai or Chennai
- Good clinical outcomes helping hospitals gain popularity by word of mouth

Improved visa issuance process

Better regulation of the medical travel ecosystem

PAINPOINTS | Lags countries like Thailand, Singapore, Malaysia, Taiwan and Mexico in providing visitors with a friendly environment and an efficient regulatory regime

- Lengthy procedures, Gaps in comfortable accommodation

Linguistic abilities of medical staff

- Few direct flights from Kochi to most of the countries from where the patients come for treatment
- Frequent scrutiny by foreigners regional registration office

A newspaper article from Times of India showcasing the booming medical tourism in Kochi, Kerala

An overview of world Medical Tourism

Country	No. Of foreigners treated (2005)	From Country	Money earned	Strengths
Thailand	600,000	US,UK	\$470m	Cosmetic surgery, Organ transplants, Dental treatments, Joint replacements
Jordan	126,000	Middle East	\$600m	Organ transplants, Fertility treatments, Cardiac care
India	100,000	Middle East, Bangladesh, UK, Developing countries	N.A	Cardiac care, Joint replacements, Lasik
Malaysia	85,000	US, Japan, Developing countries	\$40m	Cosmetic Surgery
South Africa	50,000	US,UK	N.A	Cosmetic Surgery, Lasik, Dental treatments
Cuba	N.A	Latin America, US	\$25m-50m	Specialist Niche treatments : Vitiligo, Night Blindness, Cosmetic Surgery.

Procedure	BUMRUNGRAD Hospital (Thailand) (\$-US)	Medical tourism Hospital (Kochi) (\$-US)
Heart Bypass graft surgery	7,894	5,000
Heart Valve replacement	10,000	6,000
Angioplasty	13,000	3,000
Hip replacement	12,000	5,000
Hysterectomy	10,000	2000
Bone Marrow Transplant	---	10,000
Liver Transplant	---	20,000-40,000
Neuro Surgery	---	800
Knee Surgery	8,000	1,000-2,500
Cosmetic Surgery	3,500	2,000

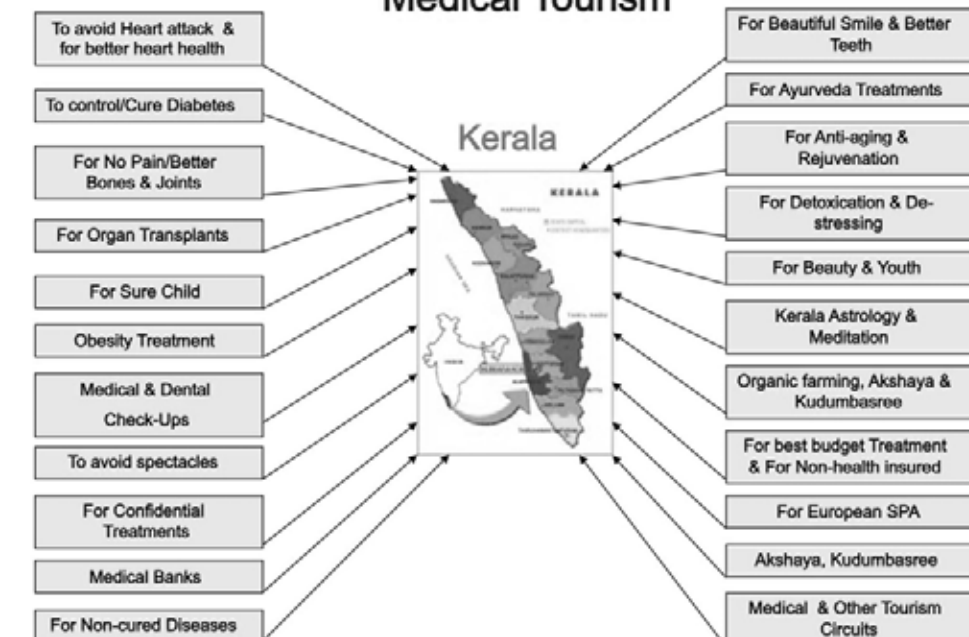
BUMRUNGRAD Hospital (Thailand):

1. Thailand population is 63,121,000
2. 3 Lakhs Foreign patients from 130 nations Treated In one year
3. 25% of patients treated are foreigners
4. Helpdesk In 12 Countries
5. Assistance in 13 languages
6. Medical Helicopter for Foreign patients

Medical Tourism Hospital (Kochi)

1. Indian population is 1,128,000,000
2. NRK Ambassadors in 160 countries
3. Cost of treatment is 30% of that of Thailand
4. Only state in India with four International Airports
5. Ayurveda -5000 years old treasure of Kerala

How kerala can be World's No.1 Destination for Medical Tourism



Challenges in Medical Tourism in Kerala

Medical tourism is a growing industry in Kerala, India, where patients travel from other countries to receive medical treatment at a lower cost than in their home country. However, there are several issues and challenges that must be addressed to ensure the sustainability and growth of the industry in Kerala. Some of these issues include:

Quality of healthcare: One of the main challenges facing medical tourism in Kerala is the need to maintain high standards of healthcare services. Patients who come for treatment expect high-quality medical care and facilities, which can be difficult to maintain consistently.

Language barriers: Many international patients face language barriers when seeking medical treatment in Kerala. This can make it difficult for them to communicate with doctors and medical staff, which can lead to misunderstandings and misdiagnosis.

Safety concerns: Safety concerns are also a major challenge for medical tourism in Kerala. Patients need to feel safe and secure when they come for treatment, and there have been instances of patients being exploited or receiving substandard treatment.

Infrastructure: Another challenge facing medical tourism in Kerala is the need for improved infrastructure. The state needs to invest in improving medical facilities, transportation, and other amenities to make it more attractive to medical tourists.

Regulatory issues: The absence of proper regulation is another major challenge facing medical tourism in Kerala. There is a need for standardized guidelines and regulations to ensure that medical tourists receive high-quality care and that healthcare providers adhere to ethical standards.

Cost-effectiveness: While Kerala offers lower medical costs than many other countries, it is still important to ensure that medical treatment is cost-effective. Medical tourists expect high-quality care at an affordable price, and there is a need to balance these two factors.

The challenges facing medical tourism in Kerala are complex, and require a collaborative effort by healthcare providers, policymakers, and other stakeholders to ensure sustainable growth and success of the industry.

Develop Medical Tourism in Kerala

Medical tourism in Kerala can be developed by implementing the following steps:

Promoting healthcare facilities: Kerala should promote its healthcare facilities that are at par with international standards. The government should invest in upgrading the medical infrastructure and technology to offer world-class services.

Tie-ups with travel agencies: Kerala should tie-up with travel agencies to promote medical tourism packages. These packages should include accommodation, travel, and healthcare services.

Medical visa facilitation: The state government should make the process of obtaining a medical visa hassle-free for patients from foreign countries. This can be achieved by establishing a dedicated medical visa cell to facilitate the process.

Quality accreditation: The hospitals and clinics in Kerala should obtain quality accreditations like Joint Commission International (JCI) and National Accreditation Board for Hospitals & Healthcare Providers (NABH) to build trust with foreign patients.

Multi-lingual support: The healthcare facilities should have multi-lingual support staff to cater to patients from different countries. This would help in removing the language barrier and provide a better experience to the patients.

Digital marketing: Kerala should leverage the power of digital marketing to promote its healthcare services to a global audience. Social media, search engine optimization, and email marketing can be effective tools for promoting medical tourism.

Specialized medical services: Kerala should focus on providing specialized medical services like Ayurveda, yoga, and alternative medicine to attract a specific segment of medical tourists who are interested in these services.

By implementing these steps, Kerala can develop its medical tourism sector and establish itself as a leading destination for medical tourism in India.



Kerala Hill Station Tourism

Kerala is home to several hill stations, which offer breathtaking views of the Western Ghats and provide a perfect escape from the scorching heat of the plains. Some of the popular hill stations in Kerala include Munnar, Wayanad, and Thekkady. These hill stations are famous for their tea and spice plantations, wildlife sanctuaries, and trekking trails. Hill tourism in Kerala attracts around 400,000 visitors annually.



Kerala, a state in southern India, is known for its picturesque landscapes, serene backwaters, lush greenery, and beautiful hill stations that attract tourists from all over the world. Hill tourism in Kerala is a popular choice among travelers seeking a peaceful retreat, away from the hustle and bustle of city life. With its pleasant weather, pristine natural beauty, and abundant wildlife, hill tourism in Kerala offers a unique and rejuvenating experience.

One of the most famous hill stations in Kerala is Munnar, located in the Western Ghats mountain range. Munnar is known for its sprawling tea plantations, mist-covered hills, and cool climate throughout the year. The lush green tea gardens in Munnar are a visual treat, offering breathtaking panoramic views of the surrounding hills. Tourists can enjoy activities such as tea tasting, trekking, and nature walks in Munnar. The Eravikulam National Park, home to the endangered Nilgiri Tahr, is another popular attraction in Munnar where tourists can spot wildlife in their natural habitat.

Another prominent hill station in Kerala is Wayanad, which is located in the northern part of the state. Wayanad is known for its dense forests, scenic waterfalls, and spice plantations. It offers opportunities for trekking, camping, and wildlife watching. The Wayanad Wildlife Sanctuary is home to several species of flora and fauna, including elephants, tigers, and various species of birds. The picturesque Chembra Peak, the highest peak in Wayanad, is a popular trekking spot and offers panoramic views of the surrounding valleys.

Apart from Munnar and Wayanad, other lesser-known but equally beautiful hill stations in Kerala include Vagamon, Ponmudi, and Idukki. Vagamon is known for its rolling meadows, pine forests, and picturesque valleys. It is also a popular spot for adventure activities such as paragliding and rock climbing. Ponmudi, located near the capital city of Thiruvananthapuram, is known for its misty hills, tea estates, and vibrant flora and fauna. Idukki, on the other hand, is famous for its dams, wildlife sanctuaries, and spice plantations. The Idukki Arch Dam, one of the largest arch dams in Asia, is a major tourist attraction in Idukki.

Hill tourism in Kerala also offers a chance to experience the local culture and traditions of the indigenous people who inhabit these regions. Tourists can interact with local communities, learn about their customs, taste local cuisine, and witness traditional art forms such as Kathakali and Theyyam. Additionally, hill tourism in Kerala also promotes eco-tourism, with several initiatives focused on preserving the fragile ecosystem of the Western Ghats and promoting sustainable tourism practices.

Hill tourism in Kerala offers a unique and tranquil experience for travelers seeking a getaway in the lap of nature. With its picturesque hill stations, lush green landscapes, abundant wildlife, and opportunities for adventure and cultural experiences, Kerala is a perfect destination for hill tourism. Whether it's the misty tea gardens of Munnar, the dense forests of Wayanad, or the picturesque valleys of Vagamon, hill tourism in Kerala promises an unforgettable journey into the lap of nature.

Issue Mapping



Munnar (1 of 20 Hill Stations in Kerala)



Thekkady (5 of 20 Hill Stations in Kerala)



Environmental degradation: Unplanned construction of hotels, resorts, and other tourism infrastructure, littering, and deforestation can all have adverse effects on the local ecology and wildlife.

Lack basic infrastructure like proper roads, sanitation facilities, and waste management systems



Traffic congestion can lead to air and noise pollution, and also make it difficult for visitors to enjoy the natural beauty of these areas.



Natural disasters

Seasonal fluctuations: Local economy is heavily dependent on the tourist footfall during the very short tourist season leading to oversupply of tourism

during the season and an undersupply during the off-season



Hill station and high range tourism in Kerala faces several challenges and issues.

Some of these include:

Environmental degradation: Hill stations and high range areas in Kerala are vulnerable to environmental degradation due to unchecked tourism activities. Unplanned construction of hotels, resorts, and other tourism infrastructure, littering, and deforestation can all have adverse effects on the local ecology and wildlife.

Traffic congestion: Popular hill stations like Munnar and Wayanad face heavy traffic congestion during peak tourism season. This can lead to air and noise pollution, and also make it difficult for visitors to enjoy the natural beauty of these areas.

Lack of infrastructure: Many of the hill stations and high range areas in Kerala lack basic infrastructure like proper roads, sanitation facilities, and waste management systems. This can create inconvenience and health hazards for both tourists and locals.

Seasonal fluctuations: Hill stations and high range areas in Kerala have a very short tourism season, which means that the local economy is heavily dependent on the tourist footfall during this period. This can lead to a situation where there is an oversupply of tourism infrastructure during the season and an undersupply during the off-season.

Lack of trained manpower: Many of the tourism service providers in hill stations and high range areas in Kerala are untrained and lack the necessary skills to provide quality service to tourists. This can lead to negative reviews and a decline in tourism.

Natural disasters: Hill stations and high range areas in Kerala are prone to natural disasters like land-slides and floods, which can disrupt tourism and cause damage to infrastructure.

It is important for the government and tourism industry stakeholders to address these issues and work towards sustainable tourism practices that benefit both tourists and the local communities.



Jatayu Earth Center, also known as Jatayu Nature Park or Jatayu Rock, is a park and tourism centre at Chadayamangalam in Kollam district of Kerala.

Kerala is known for its pristine natural beauty, and the Hill Stations and High Ranges in the state are no exception. Developing tourism in these regions can attract visitors and create job opportunities for locals. Some ways to develop Hill Station and High Range tourism in Kerala:

Infrastructure Development: The government should focus on building infrastructure like roads, bridges, and connectivity to Hill Stations and High Range areas. This will make it easier for tourists to access these places.

Promotion: Promote the Hill Stations and High Range areas in Kerala in domestic and international markets through various media like newspapers, magazines, TV channels, and social media platforms.
Eco-tourism: Promote eco-tourism in the Hill Stations and High Range areas of Kerala. Develop trekking routes, bird watching spots, and nature trails to attract nature lovers.

Adventure Tourism: Promote adventure tourism in Hill Stations and High Range areas by developing adventure sports like paragliding, rock climbing, and rappelling.

Homestays and Resorts: Encourage homestays and resorts in the Hill Stations and High Range areas to provide comfortable accommodation for tourists. Promote sustainable tourism practices in these establishments.

Local Handicrafts and Products: Encourage the promotion and sale of local handicrafts and products in Hill Stations and High Range areas to generate income for local artisans and entrepreneurs.
Cultural and Festivals: Promote cultural events and festivals in the Hill Stations and High Range areas to showcase the rich cultural heritage of the state.

A sustainable and responsible approach to tourism development is crucial to ensure the preservation of the natural beauty of the Hill Stations and High Range areas in Kerala while promoting tourism.



A beautiful landscape in the mountains of Kerala

An aerial photograph of a large concrete dam and its reservoir. The reservoir is a calm, greyish-brown body of water nestled in a lush green valley. The surrounding hills and mountains are covered in dense, vibrant green forest. In the foreground, a large, leafy tree stands prominently. The dam structure is visible on the right side of the reservoir, with a road or walkway running along its top. The sky is overcast with soft, grey clouds.

Investment Plan

Possibility of Carbon Offsetting/Credits

Carbon offsetting as an investment plan for the development of Kerala

Carbon offsetting can be a useful tool for supporting sustainable development in Kerala, which is a region that faces challenges related to climate change and environmental degradation. Here are some steps that could be taken to use carbon offsetting as an investment plan for the development of Kerala:

Identify potential carbon offset projects: There are many types of carbon offset projects that can be implemented in Kerala, such as renewable energy projects, forest conservation, and energy-efficient buildings. Identify the most suitable projects that could be implemented in the region.

Conduct feasibility studies: Before investing in any carbon offset project, it is important to conduct a feasibility study to determine the potential benefits and risks associated with the project. This could involve assessing the potential carbon savings, the financial costs and benefits, and the social and environmental impacts of the project.

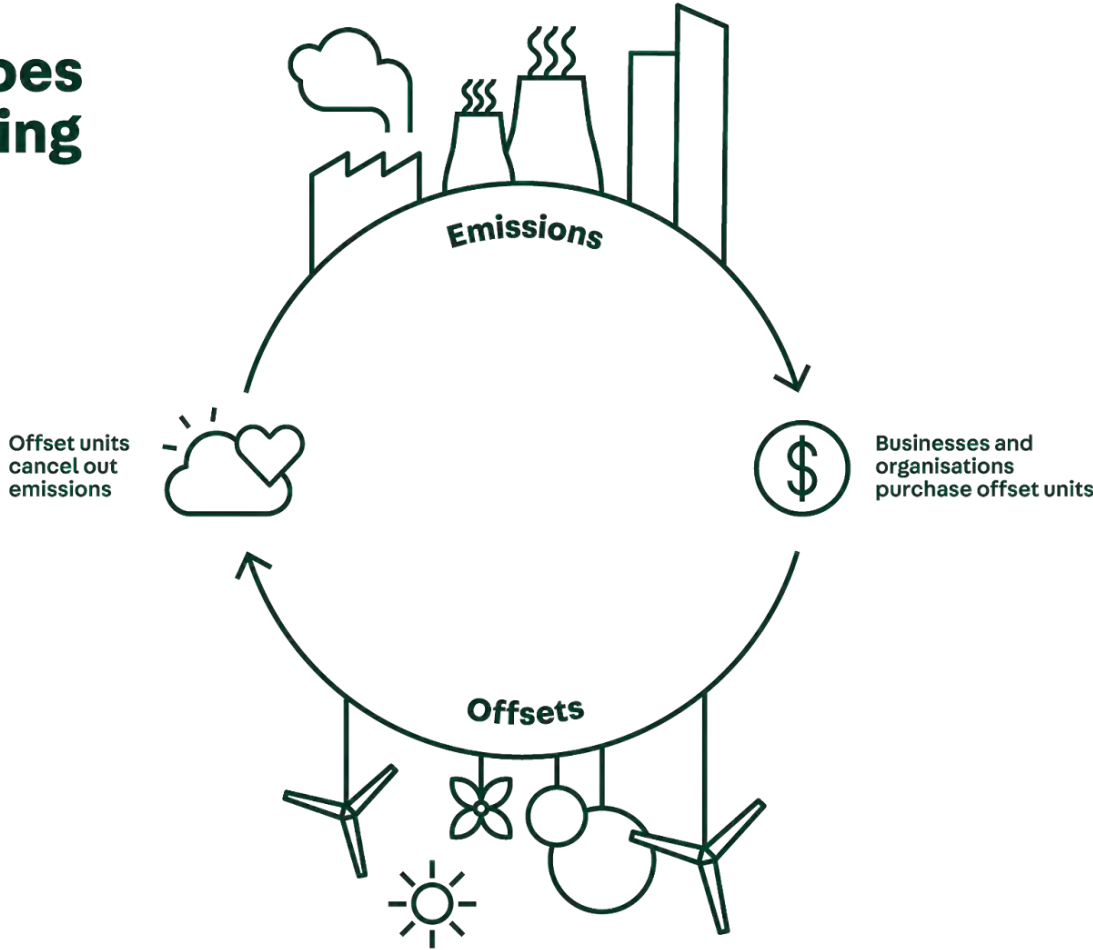
Establish partnerships: It may be necessary to establish partnerships with other organizations, such as local governments, NGOs, and private sector entities, to help fund and implement the carbon offset projects. These partnerships can also help to ensure that the projects are aligned with local development priorities and address the needs of local communities.

Develop a carbon offset portfolio: To maximize the benefits of carbon offsetting as an investment plan, it is important to develop a portfolio of projects that can generate carbon credits. This could involve investing in a mix of renewable energy, forestry, and energy efficiency projects to ensure a diversified portfolio that can generate a range of carbon credits.

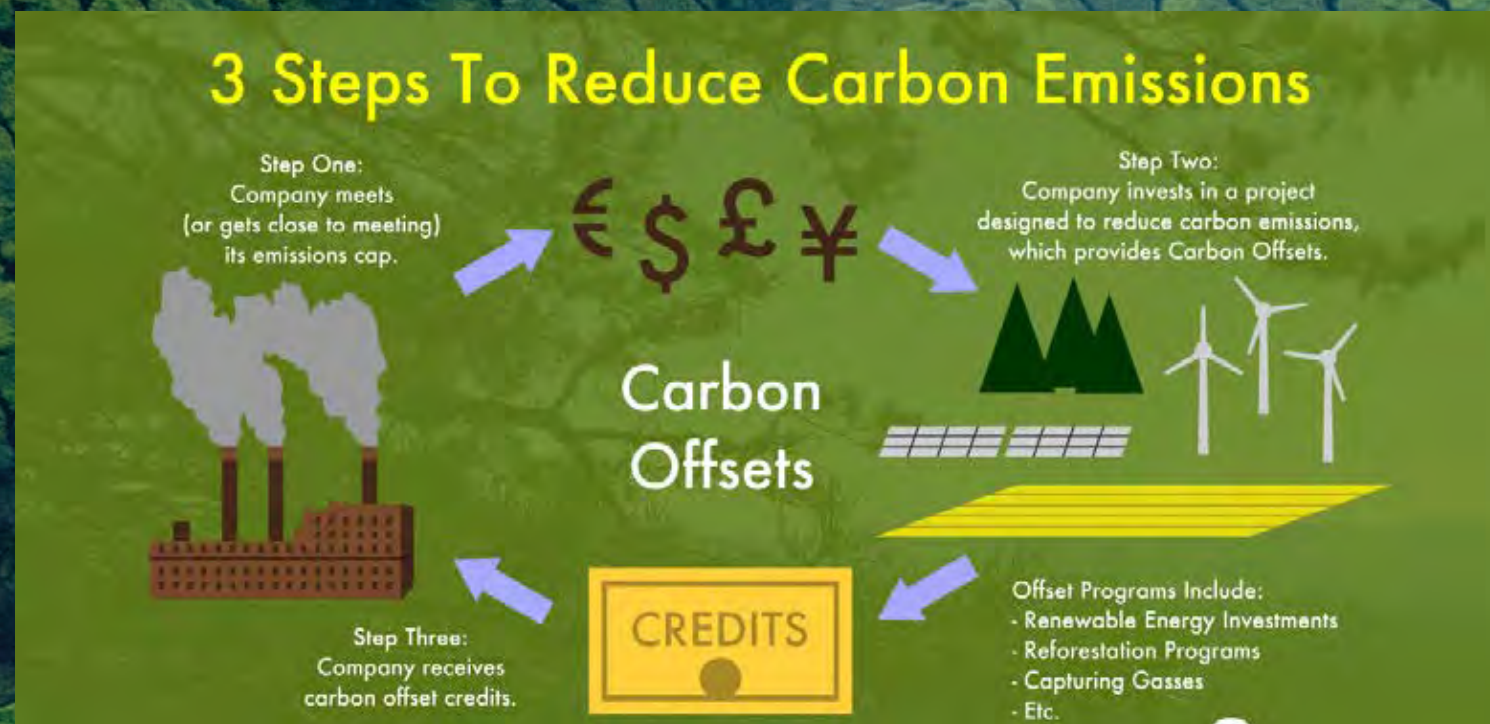
Monitor and report on project performance: It is important to monitor the performance of carbon offset projects to ensure that they are generating the expected carbon savings and contributing to sustainable development in the region. This could involve regular reporting on project performance, and verification of carbon credits by an independent third party.

Using carbon offsetting as an investment plan for the development of Kerala can help to support sustainable development in the region while also contributing to global efforts to address climate change. However, it is important to ensure that carbon offset projects are carefully selected, monitored, and implemented to maximize their potential benefits and minimize risks.

How does offsetting work?



Possible companies that can be consultancies in finding investments in carbon offsetting for the Sustainable Development of Kerala



There are many companies that may be interested in investing in carbon offsetting as part of their development plans for Kerala.

ClimateCare: ClimateCare is a UK-based company that specializes in carbon offsetting and climate finance. They work with businesses, governments, and NGOs to help them reduce their carbon emissions and invest in sustainable development projects.

Carbon Clear: Carbon Clear is another UK-based company that offers carbon management and offsetting services to businesses and organizations. They work with clients in a variety of industries to develop customized carbon reduction plans and invest in sustainable projects.

Gold Standard: Gold Standard is a certification body that sets standards for carbon offset projects and ensures that they are credible and effective. They work with a range of companies and organizations to help them invest in high-quality carbon offset projects.

Natural Capital Partners: Natural Capital Partners is a global company that offers a range of sustainability solutions, including carbon offsetting and renewable energy. They work with clients in various sectors, such as finance, healthcare, and retail, to help them achieve their sustainability goals.

EcoAct: EcoAct is a sustainability consultancy that works with businesses and organizations to reduce their carbon emissions and invest in sustainable projects. They offer a range of services, including carbon offsetting, energy efficiency, and renewable energy.



Kerala 2040

Tourist Map & Guidebook to Kerala - Implemented

The future is unpredictable, in this era of artificial intelligence, it has come to a point where nothing is impossible. Said that, the future of tourism development can be a fine line between development and destruction, and it must be certain that, we shouldn't let it slide to the latter!

The Guidebook to Kerala can fuel the state to sustainable development. The strategies developed after extensive research and case studies are presented in this book form in front of you. Implementing 'The Guidebook to Kerala' and developing the Tourist Map will give a sustainable Kerala 2040.

It is the year 2040. Kerala has undergone a tremendous transformation, becoming one of the most developed states in India. The state's development is particularly evident in its tourism industry, which has experienced exponential growth, contributing significantly to the state's economic growth.

Kerala has become a model state in terms of transportation infrastructure. An integrated circuit of transportation, mostly connected via inland waterways, has revolutionized the way people travel across the state. The state has built an extensive network of waterways, which are used as a primary mode of transportation for both goods and passengers. These waterways are integrated with airports, roads, and railways, making travel across the state a seamless experience. The state government has invested heavily in the development of these waterways, ensuring that they are maintained to the highest standards. The state's park system has been revamped, creating connected parks, coral islands, pedestrian, and bike lanes, making it easy for people to travel between districts. The state has also created a coastal lane that connects all the districts, making it easy for tourists to access sea-facing or inland waterfront resorts, beaches, and tourism hubs in every district. The state's government has ensured that every district has access to tourism infrastructure, making Kerala a tourist hotspot.

The state's development has not only focused on tourism infrastructure but also on the well-being of its citizens. The state has invested heavily in healthcare and education, ensuring that every citizen has access to quality healthcare and education. This investment has led to a healthier and more educated population, making Kerala a better place to live and work.

The state's development has been centered around sustainable practices, ensuring that the state's growth does not come at the cost of the environment. The state's tourism industry is based on eco-tourism, promoting sustainable practices and protecting the state's fragile ecosystems. The state has also invested in renewable energy, making it a leader in the adoption of green energy practices. Kerala's development has also led to the creation of jobs, reducing unemployment in the state.

The state's tourism industry has created numerous jobs, both directly and indirectly, providing opportunities for the state's youth. This has led to a reduction in brain drain, with many of the state's educated youth staying back and contributing to the state's development.

Kerala has undergone a tremendous transformation, becoming one of the most developed states in India. The state's investment in transportation infrastructure, the park system, healthcare, education, and sustainable practices has led to exponential growth in the tourism industry, creating numerous job opportunities and boosting the state's economy. Kerala has become a model state, showcasing how development can be achieved without compromising on the environment or the well-being of its citizens.



A beautiful landscape in the mountains of Kerala